



DHANALAKSHMI SRINIVASAN GROUP OF INSTITUTIONS

TRICHY | PERAMBALUR | CHENGALPATTU | SIRUVACHUR

NOT ONE, NOT TWO.. THREE... TWO DEEMED-TO-BE UNIVERSITIES & ONE STATE PRIVATE UNIVERSITY.

For us, education has never been measured by the number of institutions we establish, but by the generations we educate, empower and inspire. What began as a commitment to school education has grown into a distinguished journey of academic excellence. Today, with two Deemed-to-be Universities and one Private University, we proudly mark another significant milestone in higher education, continuing our vision of shaping knowledge, creating opportunities and building futures for generations to come.



DHANALAKSHMI SRINIVASAN UNIVERSITY

(Established Under The Tamil Nadu Private Universities Act, 2019)
Samayapuram - 621 112, Trichy, Tamil Nadu, India

Medicine | Engineering & Technology |
Allied Health Sciences | Nursing | Physiotherapy |
Pharmacy | Occupational Therapy |
Agricultural Sciences | Law | Arts & Science |
Management | Architecture



DHANALAKSHMI SRINIVASAN INSTITUTE OF RESEARCH AND TECHNOLOGY

(Deemed to be University Under Section 3 of the UGC Act)
Perambalur - 621 212, Tamil Nadu, India

Medicine | Agricultural Sciences |
Allied Health Sciences | Physiotherapy |
Arts and Science



DHANALAKSHMI SRINIVASAN INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE AND RESEARCH

(Deemed to be University Under Distinct Category
Section 3 of the UGC Act)
Siruvachur - 621 113, Perambalur, Tamil Nadu, India

Medicine | Dental | Nursing
Allied Health Sciences



On this proud occasion, we extend our heartfelt appreciation and gratitude to the students, parents, faculty, staff, administrative officials, well-wishers, and everyone who has contributed to this remarkable achievement.

FOR ADMISSIONS

Trichy : 1800 532 2222

- dsu_trichy
- dhanalakshmisrinivasanuniversity
- Dsutrty_official
- dhanalakshmisrinivasanuniversity
- DSU-trichy-campus

Perambalur : 1800 889 6622

- ds.university.perambalur
- Dhanalakshmi Srinivasan University, Perambalur
- dsgroupofficial
- dhanalakshmi-srinivasan-university-perambalur
- DSU_Perambalur

Chengalpattu : 78258 28303

- dsuniversity_chennai
- Dhanalakshmisrinivasan
- DSUmamandur
- @DhanalakshmiSrinivasanUniv-Chen

Siruvachur : 94776 94776

- dsmch.official
- Dhanalakshmi Srinivasan Medical College and Hospital
- Dhanalakshmi Srinivasan (DSMCH) Medical College and Hospital
- Dhanalakshmi Srinivasan Medical College & Hospital

Shri. A. SRINIVASAN
Hon'ble Chancellor,
Dhanalakshmi Srinivasan University



The Definitive Guide to the Stories Behind India's Most Impactful Editorials

Covering key national and international developments, this volume offers balanced perspectives, deep analysis, and valuable insights into the issues shaping our world.

 Credible journalism with
balanced viewpoints and
expert perspectives



Pre-Launch Offer *

simplifying challenges applicable | terms and conditions apply



PRE-BOOK YOUR COPY TODAY!

TO AVAIL THIS LIMITED PERIOD OFFER, SCAN QR CODE OR VISIT

newsth.live/THBookStore

For bulk booking and enquiries, contact us at bookstore@thehindu.co.in



INDIA'S PRIDE

Elavenil & Co. open Nagoya account

SPORT » PAGE 15

DRONE BARRAGE

Ukraine attack kills 2 in Russia, hits refinery

WORLD » PAGE 14

DATA POINT

The paradox of self-reliance

China-centric supply chains create an 'assembly trap' for India

OPINION » PAGE 9

DELHI SIR

Top poll official, late economist on notice list

NEWS » PAGE 10

NEARBY



Pichavaram gets another 25 h.a. of mangroves

CHENNAI
Pichavaram in Cuddalore has got another 25 hectares of mangroves owing to the efforts of the National Highways Authority of India and the Forest Department. » PAGE 6

AAI to enhance facilities at Chennai airport

CHENNAI
The Airports Authority of India has chalked out a detailed plan to enhance facilities for improved passenger experience across the domestic and international terminals at Chennai airport. » PAGE 4

EDUCATIONPLUS » PAGE 5

Tata Sons Board did not meet conditions: Trusts

Reappointment of Chandrasekaran invalid, it says, challenging the casting vote mandate at Sept. 17 Board meeting, says resolution didn't have majority support from Tata Trusts-nominated directors

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Tata Trusts, the majority owner of Tata Sons, has challenged the validity of the holding company's September 17 decision to reappoint N. Chandrasekaran as the chairman of its Board, arguing that its Articles of Association (AoA) require affirmative support from both its Trust-nominated directors. A chairman's casting – or tie-breaking – vote cannot override that condition, Tata Trusts said.

In a statement issued on Sunday, Tata Trusts also denied the existence of any deadlock at the Tata Sons Board meeting on September 17. It insisted that the casting vote by the chairman of the meeting, inde-

Power dynamics

Tata Trusts has detailed provisions of the Articles of Association of Tata Sons to challenge the reappointment of Chandrasekaran

What the majority owner says

■ As per the AoA, any decision will need affirmative support of a majority of directors nominated by it

■ There are currently two directors, Venu Srinivasan and Noel Naval Tata, nominated by Tata Trusts, and a majority will need both their votes

■ While Mr. Srinivasan voted for the resolution on the chairperson, Mr. Tata voted against it, failing the AoA condition and the resolution



Noel Naval Tata

■ Casting vote is available only where there is equality of votes at the overall Board level, which was absent here

pendent director Harish Manwani, which led to the Board approving two crucial resolutions, had no *locus standi*.

The AoA "do not leave any decision of the Board to a mere head count of directors. They provide that no decision can be taken unless it has the affirmative

support of at least a majority of the directors nominated by the Tata Trusts, who hold approximately 66% of the company," Tata Trusts said in the statement.

Stating that this was a separate condition under the AoA, the Tata Trusts said, "There are two Tata

Trusts nominees on the Board of Tata Sons [Venu Srinivasan and Noel Naval Tata]. Majority amongst two is two and not one."

'No deadlock'

"On September 17, 2026, one such director [Noel Naval Tata] voted against the resolution. Thus, the affirmative support of Tata Trusts nominee directors as mandated by the AoA was not given. The condition failed, and so did the resolution," Tata Trusts emphasised. The philanthropic body also denied any paralysis or deadlock arising from the "refusal of support" by Mr. Tata which would have entitled the chairman of the meeting to have a casting vote.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

Nepal keen to reset India ties: Minister

Suhasini Haidar
NEW DELHI

A month after the devastating Bhotekoshi floods, Nepal Prime Minister Balen Shah will make his first foreign visit since assuming office in March, travelling to New York next week to address the UN General Assembly and discuss the country's recovery plans, Nepal Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle has said.

He also confirmed that Mr. Shah's first bilateral visit would be to India later this year, and that the new government was keen to "reset" ties and move away from "jingoism" over sovereignty issues and the border dispute that has led to tensions in the past.

"The old era of jingoism and equating Nepali nationalism with anti-Indianism is over," Mr. Wagle said in an interview to *The Hindu* at the end of a three-day visit here on Saturday.

Mr. Wagle, an economist who has worked in



Swarnim Wagle

Nepal's planning commission and the UNDP, said his talks with Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar centred on the flood recovery plan, with Nepal also seeking to revise the 2009 Trade Treaty with India.

He also stressed the need for India to allow overflight permissions for international flights to Nepal's underutilised airports at Pokhara and Bhairahawa, which New Delhi has denied for the past decade citing security concerns.

INTERVIEW ON
» PAGE 11

Police probe assault on T.N. student from SC community

The Hindu Bureau
KALLAKURICHI

The police have launched an investigation into the alleged assault on a Class 12 government school student, belonging to a Scheduled Caste (SC) community, by those belonging to another community on Saturday.

The incident occurred following an argument between students belonging to different communities on the school premises in Brahmakundam village near Sankarapuram.

In the ensuing clash, the Class 12 student, identified as A. Sandeep, a resident of the same village, sustained injuries and was admitted to a private hospital.

Following the incident, parents and residents of the village staged a protest in front of the school.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 6



MANU BHAKER
Pistol Shooting

JASPRIT BUMRAH
Cricket

NEERAJ CHOPRA
Javelin Throw

HARMANPREET SINGH
Field Hockey

SAKSHI CHAUDHARY
Boxing

ABHISHEK SHARMA
Cricket

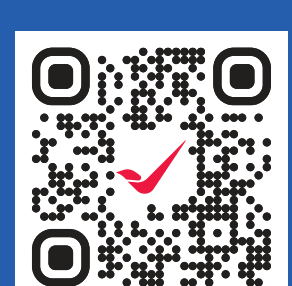
Official Retail Banking Partner



ASIAN GAMES 2026



LIFE KO BANA O RICH



SCAN TO
WATCH
THE FILM

How run clubs in the city are making people move

People across demographics show up with fellow enthusiasts at running events organised by these clubs; Vamos Run Club founder says several women go on to compete in challenging events

Sahana Mira S
CHENNAI

On a weekend around 5:30 a.m., the Elliot's Promenade is one of the most active neighbourhoods in the city, with clusters of people from different run clubs turning up for their mornings runs.

If you think back a couple of years, you would not have seen as many run clubs as there are now in 2026.

"From 18-year-olds to 40-year-olds, people across demographics attend our run club that is entirely free. There is a difference between running alone and running with people. When running with people, it pushes you to do more," says Sathish Ashwin, who founded the Vamos Run Club in June 2025, along with Keerthana Rajendran and Santhosh Gunasekaran.

He says he has always been into fitness since childhood and wanted to bring an accessible fitness community to Chennai.

"Many women who had never run before started



High spirits: Vamos Run Club founder Sathish Ashwin said the aim of the club was to bring an accessible fitness community to the city.

showing up regularly every weekend. They are winning marathons and competing in obstacle course races, too," adds Mr. Ashwin, who says roughly a hundred people show up for their runs.

At 5 a.m. on Saturdays, Nungambakkam Nitros, affiliated to Chennai Runners, is in the midst of clocking their kilometres. Sanjit Singh, who attends this run club, says he learnt the correct technique of running because of the community.

Motivation and support
"We all have different goals; some of us train for marathons whereas others try to build a routine or outdo themselves," he

says, adding that the motivation and support he gets from the running community is an experience he would never get while running alone.

"While the majority are in their 20s to 40s, we also have veteran runners over 50. We have a Chapter Coordinator who tell us the running plan for the day," adds Mr. Singh. He says the main reason he enjoys running with the group is because of the community as well as to get updates on running events around the city.

This run club does long-distance, slow-paced runs, and sometimes quick sprints at certain intervals while running. Nevertheless, every runner gets to

run at their own pace. Meanwhile, the run club that has most of the Gen Z members is the Voko Run Club, founded by S. Kavin Bharathi and Y. Vedhanthan, who are students themselves.

Apart from the run every weekend, which is the foundation of the club, they also conduct picnics, run-and-paint sessions and run-and-karaoke sessions. "We mostly have 18 to 23-year-olds joining the run club – though there is no age limit – with 100 to 150 people showing up. We have now taken up a 10-day run challenge: to run five km every day at Chetpet Eco Park," he adds, commenting on how he has seen run clubs in many cities but Chennai did not have many last year.

"We don't do hardcore running, which is why it is open to everyone. Even if people showed up to our run club just for the sake of making connections and new friends, they are moving at the end of the day by waking at 5 a.m. to run by the beach, which itself is breaking a barrier," adds Mr. Bharathi.

Residents of North Chennai demand civic infrastructure, pollution control in Manali

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI



Call for action: Federation of North Chennai Residents Welfare Association president T.K. Shanmugam addressing a grievances meeting in Manali on Sunday. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Residents of north Chennai held a meeting on Sunday to discuss civic issues in Manali and demanded civic infrastructure projects and schemes for growth and development of the polluted locality.

Residents demanded projects for flood mitigation in Manali, construction of the link road connecting Manali New Town, Sadayankuppam and Jyothi Nagar, Metro Rail connectivity between Wimco Nagar, Ennore, Manali New Town and Madhavaram, and restoration of damaged roads before monsoon.

Residents complained that the Mathur Urban Community Health Centre with 100 beds was in a bad shape and demanded its restoration with minibuses connectivity. They complained about power supply issues in Manali and demanded the government to resolve issues pertaining to issuance of patta.

Federation of North Chennai Residents' Welfare Associations president T.K. Shanmugam said Manali was the most polluted

area in the State. "United Nations Human Rights Office of the High Commissioner has accepted the report of the civil society in north Chennai as part of the study by Human Rights Council Advisory Committee on pollution in the area. Most of the polluting industries in the State are in north Chennai. The residents have requested the government to mitigate pollution and facilitate development. Pollution caused by incineration is a major issue," said Mr. Shanmugam.

'Study impacts'
Residents demanded that government study the impact of industrial pollution on public health in resi-

dential areas such as Manali, and take measures to reduce public health risk.

Periya Mathur resident Nagappan said Kadapakam Lake and Manali Lake have reduced in size. "The government should conserve the water bodies for flood mitigation. Mathur Lake should be converted to a sanctuary," he said.

Residents also demanded an emergency response centre for Manali and Ennore area. They also demanded CSR funding by polluting industries for development of residential areas.

The government should also release a white paper on employment of locals in industrial units in Manali, the federation demanded.

Rajamangalam police file case against six for disrupting gas pipeline work

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Rajamangalam police have registered a case against a 31-year-old TVK worker and five other individuals for demanding money and preventing an underground gas pipeline project from being executed in Kolathur late on Saturday.

The police said N. Dileep, a resident of West Madra Street of Kolathur, has more than seven cases pending against him. He is also a member of the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK).

According to the police, Dileep, along with the gang of five members, has been harassing the workers executing the project of a private gas agency for over a fortnight by demanding 'protection money'.

On Saturday night, the gang went to the workplace on Lakshmi Amman Koil Street of Kolathur, and threatened to stop the work if they were not paid.

Based on the complaint filed by the supervisor of the gas agency, the Rajamangalam police registered a case against Dileep and the gang members.

Experts discuss specific diagnosis and brain modulation in Alzheimer's care

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

"Treatable conditions can masquerade as Alzheimer's disease, including autoimmune disorders and thyroid inflammation," said Ennapadam S. Krishnamoorthy, founder and behavioural neurologist and neuropsychiatrist, Buddhi Clinic, stressing

the importance of a specific diagnosis in people presenting with cognitive symptoms.

He was speaking at *The Hindu* Wellness Series webinar on Alzheimer's dementia and the promise of brain stimulation, held on Sunday by *The Hindu* in association with Buddhi Clinic, to mark World Alzheimer's Day (July 20).

Dr. Krishnamoorthy said a detailed, case-based assessment was important to distinguish Alzheimer's disease from other conditions that can cause cognitive symptoms and may be treatable.

Personalised care
He also stressed the need to tailor care to the individual, noting that some me-



dications may offer limited benefits or cause harm in certain patients.

He said non-pharmacological interventions also had an important role in dementia care.

Brain stimulation
Vivek Misra, senior consultant – Neuromodulation and Clinical Neuroscience, Buddhi Clinic, discussed the potential of non-invasive brain stimulation as part of dementia

care. The technique uses external stimulation to modulate activity in specific areas of the brain, Mr. Misra said.

"It does not require sedation or seizure induction and can be done in an outpatient setting," he added. Mr. Misra said brain stimulation should not be viewed as a standalone treatment, but as one com-

ponent of a broader, precision-based approach to dementia care, with interventions tailored to the individual's clinical profile and needs.

The session was moderated by Athira Elssa Johnson, Senior Reporter, *The Hindu*.

The webinar can be viewed here: <https://newsth.live/THBCAY>

THE HINDU
DISCLAIMER: Readers are requested to verify and make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THE PUBLISHER, PVT. LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

THE HINDU PRESENTS SCHOOL BUZZ
A Newspaper exclusively curated for School Students

ANNUAL DAY CELEBRATED

Maharishi Vidya Mandir Sr. Sec. School, Choolai, managed by Sri Kanyaka Parameswari Devasthanam & Charities, celebrated their 12th Annual Day at Kamarajar Arangam, with Dr. Duraisamy A, Dean – Science and Humanities, SRM, Kattankulathur, as Chief Guest. The celebration featured a colourful cultural programme of dance and musical performances, showcasing students' creativity and confidence. The school thanked the Correspondent for continuous support, Management Committee Members for their encouragement, and Heads of Sister Institutions for their cordial presence, calling it a memorable celebration of talent, achievement and togetherness.

ANNUAL DAY AND JANMASHTAMI CELEBRATED

Kola Saraswathi Vaishnav Senior Secondary School, Kilpauk, celebrated their 52nd Annual Day and Janmashtami at Anna Centenary Auditorium, Kotturpuram. Correspondent K.K. Maheswari delivered the welcome address, with students presenting a Hindi dance drama on Meera Bai. Principal Seema Madan presented the Annual School PPT, and the Gopika e-Magazine was released. V. Srinivasan, Assistant Commissioner of Police, was Guest of Honour, and Dr. R.K. Jhaver, Chairman, Tablets (India) Limited, was Chief Guest. The programme concluded with "Evolution to AI – Revolution," and a vote of thanks by Co-opted Member Arun Mimani.

SPORTS DAY CELEBRATED

J.M. Matriculation Girls' Higher Secondary School, Chennai, celebrated their 32nd Sports Day at ICF Ground, opening with an impressive March Past, lighting of the Sports Torch, and the Sports Oath. Spectacular drills including the Sunflower Drill, Mandala Exercise, Lezims, Half-Ring Drill and Pyramid formation showcased the students' agility and coordination. Guest of Honour Mr. Charles Sam Rajadurai encouraged students to cultivate discipline, perseverance and teamwork. The Prize Distribution Ceremony honoured students for their sporting achievements, and the event concluded with a Vote of Thanks, celebrating fitness, teamwork and the true spirit of sportsmanship.

For Subscription related queries, please contact Subramaniam P:
Handphone: +91 98408 98088 | Email: subramaniam.p@thehindu.co.in

BENGALURU SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT LIMITED
Office of the Deputy General Manager-1, BSWML, 1st Floor, BMBP Building, Thimmaiah Road, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 052

No. DGM-1/BSWML/Tend/16/2026-27 Date: 19.09.2026

INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER Call-03 (Only through GOK KPP Portal Only)

The Deputy General Manager-1, Bengaluru Solid Waste Management Limited on behalf of the Managing Director, BSWML, Bengaluru invites bids from eligible bidders for the Services mentioned in the table given below.

Sl No	Name of Work	Amount Put to Tender per annum (Rs. in Lakhs)	EMD (In Rs)	Cost of Tender Document	Contract period
1	Primary Collection and Secondary Transportation of Municipal solid waste (MSW) and Street sweeping waste in Rajajinagara division (Package-9) Call-03	1,344.67	Rs.1,00,000/- through e payment mode under of the following i.e., online / RTGS/ NEFT / OTC and the balance Rs.14,00,000/- by bank Guarantee/FDR issued by Nationalized / scheduled Bank	As per e-Portal	84 Months

Calendar of events: (1) Tender documents can be downloaded from KPP Portal : **22.09.2026**. (2) Last date to upload pre-bid queries in KPP Portal : **24.09.2026 before 17:30 hrs.** (3) Tender Pre Bid meeting : **25.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. at above mentioned office.** (4) Last Date of Receipt of Tender : **05.10.2026 before 17.00 hrs.** (5) Opening of Technical Bid : **06.10.2026 after 17.30 hrs.** More details can be downloaded from website - <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>

Sd/-
Deputy General Manager-1, BSWML.

DIPR/CP/2843/SHIRDI SAI/2026-27

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru-560009. Phone No: 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-38/8361/2026-27 Date: 19.09.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

Item Rate Tenders under two cover bid system are invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors who have got adequate financial resources, state of the art technology, suitable construction equipments, technical man power & sufficient past experience for the work of :

Name of the Work: (1) Formation of asphalt road including construction of RCC Side drains, Deck slab and water supply pipeline at Road No. 1, 2 & 11 at Sub layout-8, Koorgalli Industrial Area, Mysuru Taluk, Mysuru District (2nd Call) (2) Formation of Ashphalt Road including Construction of RCC side Drains, Deck slab and water supply pipe line at Sub Layout 3, Badanaguppe-Kellamballi Industrial Area, Chamarajanagar Taluk, Chamarajanagar District. The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **06.10.2026 upto 4.00 pm.** Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>.

Sd/-
Engineer in Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/2847/SMCL/2026-27

Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

Call our toll-free number **1800 102 1878**
Or write to us at customercare@thehindu.co.in

Scan the QR code to register your feedback

THE HINDU **thehindu.businessline.**
FRONTLINE SPORTSTAR **thehindu.visionworld** **THE HINDU**

CLASSIFIEDS MART

TO ADVERTISE VISIT
www.thehinduads.com
CALL: 044-28576300 • TOLL FREE: 1800 102 4161
or Contact your nearest Authorised space sellers

PERSONAL	PERSONAL
CHANGE OF NAME	OLD AGE HOME
I, Grace Silvia Christy Vivin , wife of Thiru Vivin Joe born on 16th December 1988 (District of Birth: Chennai), residing at No 1, T V K Street, Poonamallee Road, Avadi, Chennai- 600054 shall henceforth be known as Grace Silvia Christy C	PALLIATIVE CARE at your home Trained Nurses, 24/7, Dr., Physio visits, Lab tests 1800-313-1883 tikotra.com/seniors
I, KAKE Gopi S/O Subbareddy Kake R/O Neerudrapalli, S. Ramapuram, Gopavaram, Dist. - Y S R, Andhra Pradesh. - 516235 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Venugopal Reddy Kake.	FURNITURE
I, Rehaan Khan Rahamathullah Khan, S/o. Rahamathullah Khan was born on 19 September 2007 currently residing at 6-7 Zamruth Manzil flat A2 Jinna street, Alandur, St. Thomas Mount, Chennai- 600016 and shall henceforth be known as Rehaan Khan.	ALL SOFAS, All Recliners, Recondition, Reupholstery KNS Rajan 7667133233
I, MAGI Celestine Vardon D/o George Michael Vardon R/o No. 27 Demote Avenue Opp Murari Hospital Madhavaram Chennai 600 060. have changed my name from Magi Celestine Vardon to Magi for all future purposes.	HEALTH
	HAPPY FOOT Reflexology. @ Shenoy Nagar. 60min- 999/- Ct. 90421 82828
	MARRIAGE HALLS
	Sri Krishnaswamy kalyana Mandapam - T.Nagar is available on 24th and 25th Oct 2026. Contact : 9790430125 /044-24333654
	TENDERS

BUSINESS OFFERS

COLDWELL BANKER
You've built the relationships. But can your business scale beyond you?

120 YEARS
OF GLOBAL LEGACY OF TRUST OF HOME.

FOR FRANCHISE ENQUIRIES : **81470 29068**
gopal.desai@coldwellbanker.in
cbsouthindia.com

Oushadhi
The Pharmaceutical Corporation (I.N.) Kerala Ltd.
(A Govt. of Kerala Undertaking)
Kuttanellur, Thrissur-14, Kerala
Ph: 0487-2459841, 2459807, 2459842
Email: purchase@oushadhi.org

TENDER NOTICE
OUSH/86/2026-PSA1 19-09-2026
Tenders are invited for the Supply of Raw Materials for the period 01.11.2026 to 31.03.2027. Tenders can be downloaded from www.oushadhitender.com. For more details visit Oushadhi website www.oushadhi.org or contact our Purchase Division at Kuttanellur, Thrissur.
(Sd/-) Managing Director



GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran inspecting dengue-prevention measures at Victoria hostel in Chepauk on Sunday.

City records 4,600 fever cases so far in Sept.: Corporation

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The number of fever cases reported in Chennai increased from 4,400 in August to 4,600 so far in September, according to Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC).

At a press meet on Sunday, GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran said that around 95% of dengue cases were self-limiting and managed at home, while about 5% required hospitalisation.

An analysis of fever trends over the past two months showed higher numbers in institutional areas, including IIT-Madras, Anna University, Presidency College, Victoria Hostel, and the Madras University, where large numbers of students reside.

At Victoria Hostel, students had reported issues with housekeeping, hygiene, food preparation and infrastructure. The GCC has asked the college authorities and university registrar to address the is-

sues raised and offer assistance.

Around 100 students have volunteered to join dengue prevention work with GCC field workers, Mr. Sameeran said. The Corporation has deployed 3,690 domestic breeding checkers, who cover 80 to 100 houses a day, followed by mop-up operations in identified hotspots.

At a medical camp at Anna University on Sunday, 378 people were screened. Of these, seven had fever, 44 had upper respiratory infections, six had myalgia, three had skin rashes and three had conjunctivitis, a press release said.

The GCC has collected ₹5.56 lakh in fines over the past 20 days for violations involving stagnant water, mainly from commercial institutions. Mr. Sameeran said the Corporation was conducting around 100 health camps every day, with more than 4,000 people benefiting from the camps over the past 20 days.

Lack of cleanliness, hygiene keeps exporters away from Kasimedu fishing harbour

Fishermen are forced to sell their catch at lower prices due to the lack of cleanliness. The water is black where fishes are being washed; a fisherman says the harbour has not been dredged for ages

Deepa H. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

Fish exports from Kasimedu fishing harbour comprise a rather dismal quantity of the whole. The reason? The harbour scores sub-zero when it comes to hygiene and cleanliness. Recently, a video showing maggots on blood near the fish cutting line was doing the rounds on social media.

“If the waste blood from cut fish is not removed quickly, maggots form. There are no proper drains to carry and treat such liquid wastes,” said a fisherman. Harbour users have been complaining about lack of maintenance on the premises. “We are forced to sell our catch at prices lower than those in Cuddalore or Nagapattinam owing to lack of cleanliness.



Poor upkeep: Kasimedu fishing harbour users have been complaining about lack of maintenance on the premises.

The water is black and the harbour has not been dredged for ages. We wash the fish in this water,” a fisherman said.

A boat owner said that fish wastes from markets in the city are being brought to Kasimedu where they are processed and sent to companies for use in the cosmetic industry. “The waste raises such a stink that just crossing the location leaves the stench on our clothes. Though com-

plaints have been filed with the local police, the Chennai Port’s harbour management committee and fisheries AD, no action has been initiated against these people,” said a fisherman.

The internal roads are not properly paved and connected. “The road outside the harbour has huge potholes. There is no drinking water supply since the overhead tank is still under construction.

**Timings**
CHENNAI

MONDAY, SEP. 21
RISE 05:58 SET 18:06
RISE 14:26 SET 01:10

TUESDAY, SEP. 22
RISE 05:58 SET 18:05
RISE 15:09 SET 02:02

WEDNESDAY, SEP. 23
RISE 05:58 SET 18:05
RISE 15:50 SET 02:53

Chennai Weather

max	min
Tiruvallur 34	24
Chennai Airport 36	26
Chennai City 37	27

Chennai Airport Today
36°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. The night will be comfortable. A spell of light to moderate rain and thundershowers may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
35°C The morning will be comfortable. The day will be warm. The night also will be comfortable. Moderate rain and thundershowers may occur.

© Copyright Skymet Weather 2026
All rights reserved.

**NLC India Limited**
(“Navratna” - Government of India Enterprise)
Regd. Office: No.135, EVR Periyar High Road, Kilpauk, Chennai-600 010
Corporate Office: Block-1, Neyveli - 607 801,
Cuddalore District, Tamil Nadu.
CIN: L33090TN1956G0003307 Website: www.nlcindia.in

NLC India Limited – Shorts / Reels Contest
As a part of Vigilance Awareness Week - 2026 Celebrations Conducted by NLCIL, Shorts/Reels are invited for the “Shorts/Reels Contest” on the following theme:
**“Probity for Prosperity”
“Integrity Drives Growth”**
Last Date of Submission : 18.10.2026
“Please Visit the “Latest News” Section on NLC India’s Website: <http://www.nlcindia.in/>”
PUBLIC SECTOR IS YOURS : HELP IT TO HELP YOU


Scan QR Code

Depositors of finance firm to stage protest seeking govt. action

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Hundreds of aggrieved depositors of the Mylapore Hindu Permanent Fund Nidhi Limited (MHPFNL) have planned to go on a peaceful protest near Rajarathinam stadium in Egmore on Monday to seek the intervention of the State government to take speedy action to recover the funds, and distribute it to the depositors.

Over 6,000 depositors More than 6,000 depositors, comprising senior citizens and persons with disabilities, lost their funds due to a financial fraud which happened under the management of T. Devan-

than Yadav, chairman and managing director of 151-year-old MHPFNL, in 2024.

Mohan Srinivasan, president of the Mylapore Fund Aggrieved Depositors Association, said that though the Economic Offences Wing of the City Police had arrested Yadav on August 13, 2024, the ₹700 crore financial fraud case has been progressing slowly, with the recovery of the depositors’ money getting delayed for more than three years.

Mr. Srinivasan said the association wanted the intervention of the State government by forming a fast-track special court for conducting the trial expeditiously on a day-to-day basis.

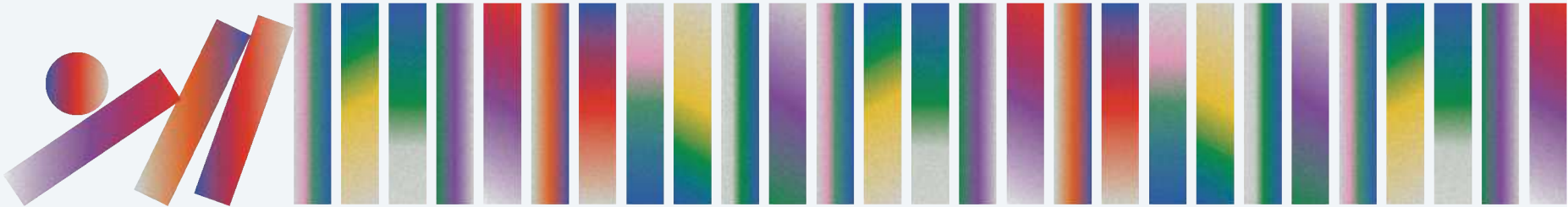


AVAILABLE ONLY FOR
₹ 28* / 450g

Amul CURD

Also available in 900 g at ₹54*
for trade inquiry, contact : 7200143027, 8778475804

CELEBRATING THE QUIET DREAMERS WHO DRIVE POWERFUL CHANGE.



They are the visionaries who dream quietly and act with intent. Their steady pursuit of progress turns belief into action, and action into a future we can all look forward to.

The Hindu businessline Changemaker Awards 2026 celebrates these leaders of change, recognising the ones who challenge the ordinary and set in motion ripples that transform lives and communities.

Join us live as we applaud the changemakers shaping tomorrow.



CHIEF GUEST

Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman
Honourable Minister of Finance and Corporate Affairs, Government of India



Scan the QR code or visit thbl.news/BLCM2026 to subscribe and watch the event.

SASTRA
DEEMED UNIVERSITY
THANJAVUR - KUMBAKONAM - CHENNAI

Presents

thehindu**businessline**.
CHANGE
MAKER
awards RECOGNISING HUMAN CATALYSTS

Powered by

CITY UNION BANK

September 22 | 6 pm onwards | New Delhi

Presenting Partner

SASTRA
DEEMED UNIVERSITY
THANJAVUR - KUMBAKONAM - CHENNAI

Powered by

CITY UNION BANK

Associate Partners



Mobility Partner

INBRIEF



Ramakrishna Mission Ashrama honours its alumni, teachers

The Ramakrishna Mission Ashrama Schools' Alumni Association on Sunday conferred the Distinguished Alumni Awards on Maj. Gen. S. Venkataraman, musician Rajkumar Bharathi, and paediatrician Bhaskar Raju, and honoured 11 retired teachers on its Alumni Day. Secretary of Ramakrishna Mission Ashrama, Swami Padmasthanandaji; industrialist Nalli Kuppuswami Chetti; and alumni association president S. Seetharaman, vice-president K.V.S. Gopalakrishnan, secretary D. Chandrasekhar, and treasurer S. Kedarnath were present.

34th Prof. Brahm Prakash Memorial Materials Quiz held

A total of 43 teams, comprising 86 school students from across India, took part in the 34th Prof. Brahm Prakash Memorial Materials Quiz conducted by the Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research, along with the Indian Institute of Metals - Kalpakkam Chapter, and inaugurated by Anish Kumar, Director, Metallurgy and Materials Group.

Festivities end



People gather in large numbers during the immersion of Vinayaka idol at Pattinapakam beach on Sunday. R. RAGU

T.N. mid-level healthcare providers demand job regularisation

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu Mid-Level Healthcare Providers' Union has handed over a representation to Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, seeking job regularisation, basic salary hike, paid maternity leave, and the official re-designation of Mid-Level Healthcare Providers (MLHPs) as Community Health Officers.

The union, which represents 4,848 health and wellness centres in the State, said in its memorandum that MLHPs deliver 12 packages of services and perform 14 types of medical tests. Contractual MLHPs draw a basic salary of ₹21,000, up from ₹18,000, while their counterparts in other States receive ₹60,000 to ₹70,000, alongside monthly incentives, the petition said.

At a press meet on Sunday, the union's State president N. Sundari, secretary R. Jeyasurya, and treasurer P. Surya urged the State to ensure the proper utilisation of Jan Arogya Samiti funds. They alleged that the funds – managed via joint bank accounts by village panchayat presidents and primary health centre medical officers – were not being properly utilised for health centre activities or meetings.

AAI plans slew of changes at airport for improved passenger experience

Officials say they have identified issues faced by passengers and made a detailed plan to enhance various facilities. They will improve signage, create workstations, and upgrade furniture. Move follows T.N.'s letter to Centre to change airport operator

PORT CALL

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

The Airports Authority of India (AAI) has chalked out a detailed plan to enhance various facilities – from improving signage to creating workstations – across the domestic and international terminals at Chennai airport.

AAI officials said that over the last few weeks, they had carefully identified all the issues faced by the passengers and had made an extensive proposal to rectify them.

These plans come soon after the letter from the Tamil Nadu government to the Centre, seeking to change the operator of the city airport.

One of the major complaints is the lack of signage in the terminals, officials said. “We have



For easy navigation: The size of the new signboards, expected to be installed within four months, will be increased significantly and will also be well illuminated. FILE PHOTO

identified the spots where the signage is missing or is inadequate. In the new signboards, the distance between the terminals too will be mentioned. Also, the size of the board will be increased significantly in all the earmarked areas and they will be well illuminated to catch the atten-

tion of passengers. This will improve wayfinding to a great extent,” an official said. The new boards are expected to be installed within four months, the officials said.

The AAI will also have display boards to indicate the waiting time above each queue at the security

check. “Usually, people take a look and go by their hunch about which line might have the shortest waiting time. Now, we plan to fix boards displaying live waiting time above each line to help passengers,” an official said.

The type of furniture in the terminals too, will be

changed; plastic chairs may be replaced with sofas and more murals reflecting the State's heritage will be added to elevate the ambience, officials said.

“We also plan to create workstations where passengers will have comfortable furniture to sit and work on their laptops, allowing them to utilise the time before boarding. This will be useful for thousands who travel for work,” the official further said.

In addition to these changes, accessible charging points, more greenery, and improvements in baby care rooms too will also be introduced. “We will work towards drastically upgrading the terminals and providing a better experience,” he said.

However, these plans must be approved by the AAI headquarters in New Delhi before they could be implemented, sources said.

Man killed in hit-and-run, search on for truck driver

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 32-year-old motorist was killed in a hit-and-run case involving a container truck on Poonamallee High Road near Vanagaram on Saturday night.

A senior official of the Avadi police Commissionerate said V. Dileep, a resident of Lakshmi Nagar in Alapakkam near Maduravoyal, was working as a delivery agent for a private online delivery company.

He was returning home after delivering a parcel around 11.30 p.m. on Saturday when an unidentified container truck hit his two-wheeler from behind and drove away.

Dileep suffered serious injuries and was rushed to the Government Kilpauk Medical College Hospital for treatment. However, he died within an hour of admission.

The Maduravoyal Traffic Investigation police have registered a case and are searching for the truck driver.

High Court refuses to grant terminal benefits to man who faked ST status to claim job reservation

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court has found that a Caste Hindu had joined the Chennai Port Trust (CPT) in 1982 in a post reserved for a Scheduled Tribe (ST) candidate, served the organisation for 32 years by prolonging the inquiry into his caste status, and attained the age of superannuation in 2013, thereby depriving a person suffering social stigma of constitutional benevolence.

Justice D. Bharatha Chakravarthy dismissed

the writ petitions filed by A. Jegannathan and refused to interfere with the State Level Scrutiny Committee's (SLSC) conclusion that the petitioner actually belonged to Urali Gounder community and not the Urali tribe. The judge also refused to direct CPT to pay full pension or release other terminal benefits.

He said a community certificate produced by the petitioner to claim reservation was referred to the Salem Collector for verification by CPT in 1983 itself. On verification, the revenue officials found that the

petitioner had actually studied in Tiruchi district and was identified as belonging to Urali Gounder community in his school records. Therefore, in 1984, the collector informed CPT that the community certificate was fake, and the writ petitioner had failed to prove his tribal status despite having been accorded an opportunity to do so.

Aggrieved over it, Mr. Jegannathan filed a writ petition in 1985 and got the Collector's order quashed in 1986. Then, the High Court ordered a fresh inquiry, which concluded in

1990, confirming that the petitioner was a Caste Hindu and not an ST. He was discharged from the services of CPT on September 26, 1990. But the petitioner filed another writ petition and got an interim stay of the discharge order. The High Court ordered a re-inquiry into his caste status.

Thereafter, the inquiry got prolonged due to it being shuttled between the SLSC and the District Level Scrutiny Committee, and the delay led to his attaining the age of superannuation. It was only in 2021 that the SLSC concluded

that the petitioner had produced a bogus community certificate. Hence, the petitioner urged the court to quash the SLSC's conclusion as it was passed without hearing him.

However, the judge said the SLSC had arrived at the conclusion on the basis of documentary evidence, as the petitioner failed to appear for inquiry. Since there was overwhelming evidence against the petitioner, the SLSC's order could not be interfered with on sole ground of violation of principles of natural justice, the judge said.

Technology Development Board
Department of Science & Technology Block - II, 2nd Floor,
Technology Bhawan, New Mehrauli Road, New Delhi - 110016
Website: www.tdb.gov.in

TENDER NOTICE

Tender/EOI Reference No.: TDB-140R/1/2026 Date: 21.09.2026

TDB invites Expressions of Interest (EOIs) from reputed and experienced Chartered Accountant Firms for empanelment to provide professional services in connection with the Technology Development Board - Research, Development and Innovation Fund (TDB-RDIF). The empanelled Firms will assist TDB in undertaking financial, accounting, monitoring, audit, due diligence, compliance, and other related assignments as may be required for the effective implementation and management of the TDB-RDIF.

The EOI document is available on the TDB website, i.e. www.tdb.gov.in. Interested Firms may download the EOI documents from the website and submit their proposals.

The last date of receipt of Tender 14.10.2026 before 17:00 Hrs at TDB, Technology Bhawan, New Delhi.

CBC 36106/11/0006/2627 Under Secretary TDB

தொழிலாளர் வருங்கால வைப்பு நிதி நிறுவனம்
कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन
EMPLOYEES' PROVIDENT FUND ORGANISATION

தொழிலாளர் மற்றும் வேலைவாய்ப்பு அமைச்சகம், இந்திய அரசு
श्रम एवं रोजगार मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार
Ministry of Labour and Employment, Govt. of India

மண்டல அலுவலகம் தாம்பரம்
மேலதர அலுவலகம், 3, ராஜாஜி சாலை, பரிகாச தாம்பரம்
3, Rajaji Salai, West Tambaram, Chennai - 600 045
தலைப்பு - 600045
Tel.: 044-2226 1925 / 1935/2297/4376/97/98; Toll Free Number: 1800 425 6749
E-mail: ro.tambaram@epfindia.gov.in
Facebook: @EPFOtambaram; Twitter: @epfotambaram; Website: www.epfindia.gov.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

EPF Wage Ceiling Raised to ₹25,000

The Union Cabinet, chaired by the Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, has approved the proposal of the Ministry of Labour & Employment to enhance the wage ceiling for mandatory EPFO coverage from Rs.15,000 to Rs.25,000 per month. The decision is expected to bring more than 51 lakh additional employees under mandatory EPFO coverage.

The enhanced coverage will provide access to Provident Fund savings, pension protection under EPS and insurance protection under EDLI, as per the applicable provisions. It will also align the statutory contribution and pensionable-wage framework with prevailing wage levels.

EPFO Regional Office, Tambaram currently has 3,82,450 contributory members. The measure is expected to further promote formalisation of employment, worker retention and long-term retirement security, while strengthening social security coverage and workforce stability.

Employers are advised to take necessary measures for implementation of the enhanced wage ceiling and ensure compliance with the applicable statutory provisions w.e.f. 17.09.2026.

The decision supports the development of an inclusive, resilient and future-ready social security system alongside economic growth, rising wages and expanding formal employment towards Viksit Bharat@2047.

Shri Ritesh Pawha, Regional PF Commissioner-I, Tambaram (Guindy), stated that the initiative will significantly enhance retirement and insurance protection for workers.

Sd/
Place : Tambaram
Date : 18.09.2026

Regional PF Commissioner-I
Regional Office, Tambaram - Guindy

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

Mr. J. Wilson Sundara Raj
Former Law Secy, Govt. of Mizoram and
Retd. as Jt. Secy, Govt. of TN
Born 04.10.1927
Called Home: 20.09.2026

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

9th DEATH ANNIVERSARY
DOB: 25.01.1938 DOD: 21.09.2017
SRI M.V.SUBRAMANIAM (Retd. S.E. Ry.)
S/o. Late V. Menakrishna Sundaram, Saidapet, Chennai
(CHADALAWADA FAMILY)
KARMANYE VINDHI KARASTE MA PRAEESHO KADACHANA
You have a right to perform your duty but not to the fruits of your actions. His life was devoted to purpose and tireless endeavor.
We pay tribute to his legacy which lives on and inspires us everyday. He is Sage of steady wisdom.
From Near & Dear, 9891104521

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

18th ANNIVERSARY
K.SURESH, B.E.,
(Structural Consultant)
Unides Consultants
10.04.1967 - 21.09.2008
Fondly Remembered by
Y. Malik Kabur
ESS EMM BUILDERS, Chennai.

IN MEMORIAM

G. Kasturi
17-12-1924 — 21-09-2012

DEATH

Mrs. MARGARET (MAGGIE) DAWSON
Passed away on 10.09.2026
Ex. Cookson & Syntel
Funeral Service on 22.09.2026,
at 1.00 PM at St. Patrick's Church,
St. Thomas Mount, Chennai - 16.
Deeply mourned by Family & Friends
9789942444 - Mr. Bede Vanhaltren

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

EIGHTH ANNIVERSARY
N. RAMAMOORTHY, B.Com, B.L., FCA
28-05-1963 - 21-09-2018
“Forever in our Hearts & Souls”
Father - Mother - Wife - Son - Daughter-In-Law - Brother - Sisters
‘Sundaram’, No.14, 54th Street, Ashok Nagar, Chennai - 600 083

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

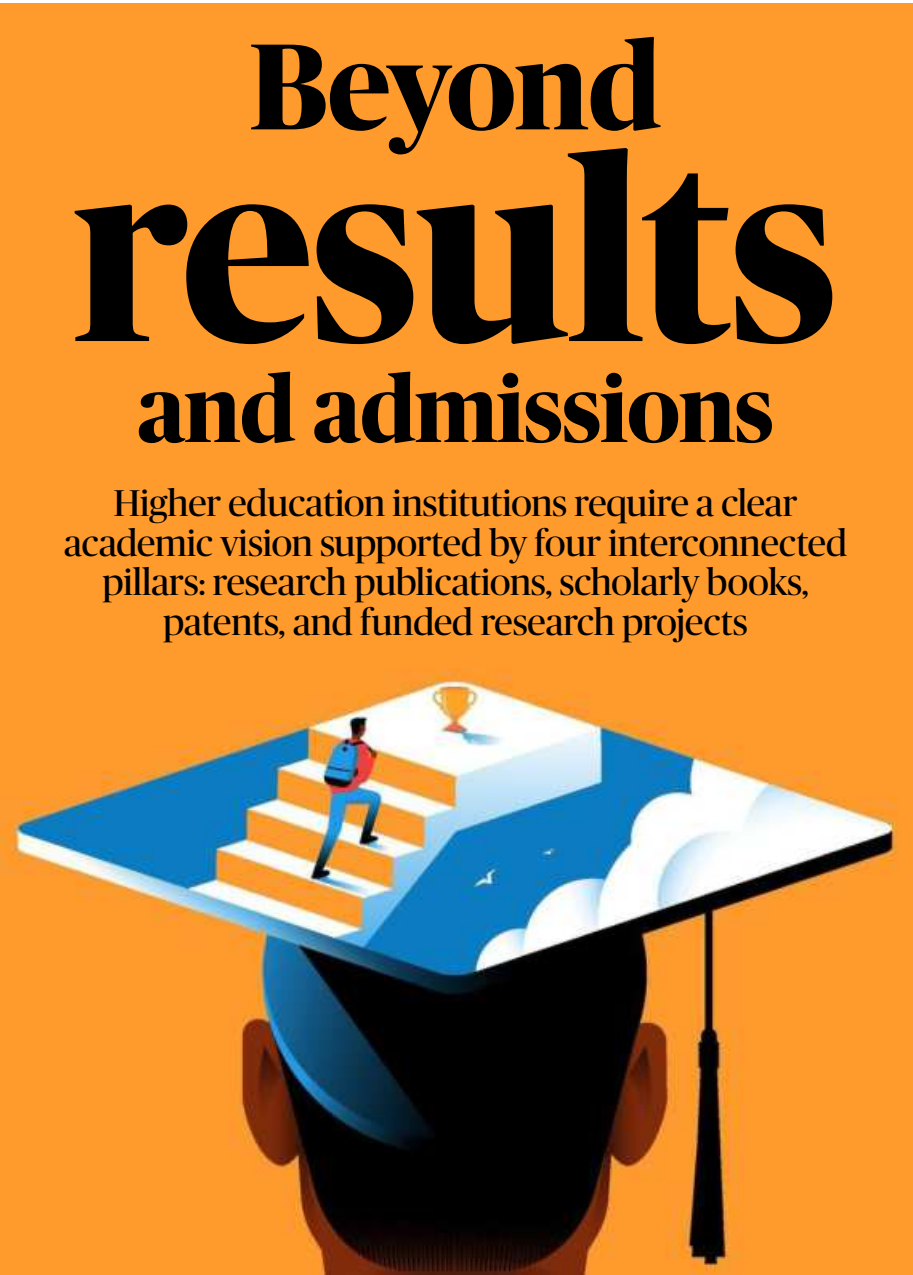
IT'S HARD TO FORGET SOMEONE
WHO GAVE YOU SO MUCH TO REMEMBER

Ninth Year Remembrance

Shri. M. K. Unnithan
(1932 - 2017)
FOUNDER CHAIRMAN
SANKAR GROUP OF COMPANIES
Fondly Remembered and Revered by Family Members

EDUCATIONPLUS

GET THE EDGE Follow us facebook.com/thehindu x.com/the_hindu instagram.com/the_hindu



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Y.R.M. Rao

Every year, higher education institutions invest significant effort in attracting students through advertisements, outreach programmes, educational fairs, and admission campaigns. Many expect faculty members to participate in admission-related and various administrative activities that extend beyond their core academic roles. While student enrolment and institutional sustainability are undeniably important, the increasing diversion of faculty time towards non-academic functions often leaves limited scope for meaningful engagement in research, innovation, and scholarly pursuits. Consequently, many institutions continue to be evaluated primarily on examination results, placements, and admissions rather than on their contribution to knowledge creation. In an era driven by innovation and global competitiveness, this calls for a re-examination of institutional priorities. The true strength of a higher education institution lies not merely in the number of students it admits or graduates, but in its ability to generate new knowledge, solve real-world problems, and contribute to societal progress through sustained research and innovation. As India aspires to emerge as a global knowledge hub, institutions must move beyond their traditional role as centres of instruction and evolve into centres of discovery, innovation, and intellectual leadership. This transformation requires a clear academic vision supported by four interconnected pillars: research publications, scholarly books, patents, and funded research projects. **Research:** The publication of quality research papers, which are the most visible expression of scholarly activity and intellectual contribution, enables faculty members to share new findings, challenge existing assumptions, and advance knowledge within their disciplines. Publications in reputed journals enhance academic visibility, encourage collabora-

tion, and establish credibility among peers. More importantly, research-active faculty members bring fresh perspectives into the classroom, ensuring that students learn not only established concepts but also emerging developments shaping their fields. This transforms teaching from the transmission of existing knowledge into an engagement with new knowledge. **Publications:** Books and scholarly works represent a deeper and more comprehensive engagement with a subject than is often possible through articles alone. They allow educators to synthesise knowledge, document experiences, and present

original insights in a structured manner. Scholarly writing contributes to the academic ecosystem by creating valuable resources for students, researchers, and professionals. Faculty members who author books help build intellectual capital that continues to influence learning long after individual lectures have ended. **Innovation:** Research achieves its fullest value when it moves beyond theory and finds practical application. Patents recognise originality and demonstrate the researchers' ability to transform ideas into useful products, processes, or technologies. They serve as evidence that academic

work can address industrial, technological, and societal challenges. Institutions that promote innovation and patent generation cultivate a culture of creativity, problem-solving, and entrepreneurship, which are increasingly essential in the modern knowledge economy. Patents also strengthen the links between academia and industry, ensuring that research outcomes contribute directly to economic and social development. **Funded research projects:** Securing grants from government agencies, industries, and international organisations testifies to the quality and relevance of a researcher's ideas. Funded projects provide resources to investigate complex problems, develop infrastructure, foster interdisciplinary collaboration, and engage students in meaningful research experiences. They often lead to a cycle of publications, patents, consultancy opportunities, and societal impact. Institutions with strong research funding portfolios are generally better positioned to contribute to national priorities and global academic discourse. The responsibility to strengthen these four pillars does not rest solely with faculty members. Management and academic administrators must create enabling environments through supportive policies, research infrastructure, incentives, reduced procedural barriers, and a culture that values scholarly achievement. Faculty members, in turn, must view research not as an additional obligation but as an integral component of their academic identity. When these efforts converge, institutions become more than centres of teaching; they become centres of knowledge creation and innovation. The writer is an academic, administrator, researcher, and author with over four decades of experience in Engineering education and institutional development.

S.A. COLLEGE OF ARTS & SCIENCE

With the Blessings of Our Beloved Founder Chairman
Thiru. D. Sudharssanam

Graduation Day

10:00 AM

23rd Sept Wednesday

SACAS Premises

Chief Guest
Thiru. Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar
Hon'ble Governor of Tamil Nadu and Kerala

Thiru. D. DURAISWAMY
Chairman
Will Preside over the Function



OFF THE EDGE
Nandini Raman

I am 25 with a Bachelor's in Anthropology and a Master's in English Literature, but still struggling to find a job. Should I pursue short-term courses in AI, Data Analytics or Cybersecurity without a technical background, or another Master's abroad in Anthropology or a related field? Sanskar

Dear Sanskar,

It must be frustrating to hold two solid degrees and not be employed yet! You probably need to make your application more marketable. Moving into tech or corporate domains using short-term courses is one strategy, but you must choose the right niche. For Data Analytics, focus on Excel, SQL, and Power BI/Tableau. AI (Prompt Engineering and AI Operations) is also great. Cybersecurity is highly technical. Without a technical background, the learning curve is steep. Explore UX Research. The core job is to interview users, observe behaviours, and write clear product recommendations. In around six months, you can learn Figma, Usability Testing and Information Architecture. Consider studying abroad for a specific purpose and not to get a generic academic degree. Avoid M.A. Literature/Anthropology unless you are looking for an academic or research-oriented career. Opt for applied interdisciplinary degrees such as Digital Anthropology, HCI, or Medical

Focus on the role

Uncertain about your career options? Low on self-confidence? This column may help

Anthropology/Global Health in the U.K. (UCL, Manchester or Sussex); Interactive Digital Media or Public Culture Studies in Ireland (Trinity College Dublin or UCD); or Intercultural Communication or Cognitive Science in Germany.

I have completed BBA LL.B. and have three years of litigation experience. I am pursuing a Master's in Public Policy, Law and Governance. What jobs or internships should I target for a well-paid job with opportunities to work internationally? Anshula

Dear Anshula,

To move into the international domain, transition from traditional litigation and move towards the intersection of tech, trade, compliance, and international law. Policy and AI Governance involves data privacy, AI regulation, and content moderation across jurisdiction. International Trade and Competition Law involves cross-border transactions, mergers, trade disputes and global competition compliance. ESG and Climate Policy roles at MNCs involve supply-chain audits, carbon credits and international climate compliance. Do not be a generalist. Pick one domain and align your projects, research and internships accordingly. For Public Policy and Government Relations, consider Google, Microsoft, Amazon, or Reliance. For

International Trade/Policy, explore law firms such as Shardul Amarchand Mangaldas, Khaitan & Co and Trilegal. Think tanks such as Vidhi, ORF and CPR offer policy research roles, while EY, Deloitte, PwC, KPMG, McKinsey and BCG offer government and risk advisory opportunities.

I am pursuing a certificate course in Urdu and plan to be a language translator. What are my career options? Sahil

Dear Sahil,

To build a career as a language translator, ensure your English-to-Urdu or Hindi-to-Urdu skills are equally strong. Most online jobs require translating source text from English. Master Computer-Assisted Translation (CAT) tools such as SDL Trados, MemoQ, or Smartcat. Create profiles on Upwork, Freelancer, and ProZ and upload mock translations of legal contracts, medical brochures, or creative subtitles to showcase your expertise. Get certified by recognised professional bodies and national translation guilds. Your career options span traditional media, global corporate ecosystems, and the tech landscape of 2026. Look at technical and corporate roles such as AI Training and Language Alignment Specialist. Explore media, entertainment and publishing industries for subtitling and dubbing roles

in the OTT space. Urdu news portals also need translators for global press releases, wire copy, and international reports. Across government and intergovernmental sectors, explore departments, ministries, and embassies that hire translators for bilateral documentation and trade communications. The UAE, Saudi Arabia, and Qatar offer roles across English, Arabic, and Urdu.

I have finished Class 12 and am interested in a job in the defence forces. I am also good at football. Will sports certificates from college help me get in or do I have to work on my physical and exam preparations? Devika

Dear Devika,

For women, entry as an officer to the Defence Forces is through the National Defence Academy (NDA) written exam after Class 12 or the Officers Training Academy (OTA) via the CDS exam after graduation. While sports achievements can help in the Services Selection Board (SSB) interview, the exams are mandatory and there is no exemption on the basis of sports certificates. Outstanding state, national, or international sports certificates let you apply for direct non-commissioned officer ranks like soldier/JCO roles like Havildar or Naib Subedar under the Indian Army sports quota. **Disclaimer: This column is merely a guiding voice and provides advice and suggestions on education and careers.** The writer is a practising counsellor and a trainer. Send your questions to eduplus.thehindu@gmail.com with the subject line Off the Edge

MAHARISHI VIDYA MANDIR SENIOR SECONDARY SCHOOL

VIDYARAMBAM

VIJAYADASHAMI ADMISSIONS OPEN

INFRASTRUCTURE AND FACILITIES

- Spacious and well-ventilated classrooms with Interactive Smart Boards
- Wi-Fi enabled Science and Computer Labs
- Well-equipped Library for Students and Staff
- State-of-the-art Robotics, Artificial Intelligence and FYULE Labs
- Safe and Sound Playground facilities for outdoor and indoor games
- Scouts and Guides, JRC and NGC
- Expertise training with Comprehensive study materials NEET, JEE and Olympiads
- Well-equipped hostel facilities.

Unique Features:
Transcendental Meditation - An Important Aspect of Consciousness-Based Education.
• Promotes Values, Discipline and Emotional Stability.
• Builds Creativity, Confidence and Clarity in Thinking.
• Reduces Stress and Anxiety.

Scientifically Proven benefits of Academic Excellence and Well-being.

www.mvmschoolschetpet.com | www.mvmschoolsavadi.com | www.mvmschoolpolachery.com | www.mvmschoolirungattukottai.com | www.mvmschoolkumbakonam.com | www.mvmschooltenkasi.com | www.mvmschooltrichy.com

Call: Chetpet: 044 26427088 | Avadi: 72400 02000 | Polachery: 9566232222 | Irungattukotai: 9003260000 | Kumbakonam: 8940401014/18 | Tenkasi: 7867868674 | Iluppur: 9566164444

M CH-CHE



Serious escalation

The new U.S. law on Russian oil imports carries more legal weight

The U.S. Russia Sanctions Act, now signed into law by President Donald Trump, and its resultant impending tariffs, present a new and substantially different escalation of tensions between the U.S. and India. The law provides the U.S. President the authority to levy tariffs of up to 100% on countries such as India that import large quantities of Russian oil and gas. This is more serious than the penal tariffs that Mr. Trump had levied earlier. The escalation last year of reciprocal tariffs to 50% on India's import of Russian oil was based on an Executive Order, and could be rescinded through the same method. This latest Act has been passed by the U.S. Congress and so carries a higher order of legal permanence and authority. Mr. Trump will have to justify in writing to Congress any waiver he wants to provide. The 50% tariffs hit Indian exports to the U.S. hard, but the impact was somewhat mitigated by exporters sharing the cost with their American customers. That was, however, a financially devastating and unsustainable bid to retain customers. Sharing a 100% tariff will be impossible for India's largely micro, small and medium enterprises (MSME) exporters. The 100% tariffs are also over and above the 10% 'forced labour' tariffs and the 50% Section 232 tariffs on steel and aluminium. Indian exports to the U.S. will simply become too uncompetitive should these new tariffs come to pass. India has three options before it: cut Russian oil imports, retain those imports and bear the tariffs, or convince the U.S. to implement a low tariff using the "up to 100%" phrasing of the law.

Continuing with Russian oil imports and bearing the tariffs would be a significant blow to India's export ambitions and MSMEs. The U.S. is India's largest export destination, accounting for about 20% of its total goods exports. In any case, historical data have shown that India has usually complied with U.S. pressure to cut oil imports from particular countries, including from Russia, vocal claims of strategic autonomy aside. Finding other sources will be difficult. Russia accounted for more than 51% of India's oil imports as of July 2026, while supplies through the Strait of Hormuz remain constrained. India will have to chivy countries such as Oman to hasten their expansion of alternative ports. The price of oil remains well above \$100 a barrel, meaning finding favourable deals with new suppliers will be increasingly difficult. Union Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal will have much to do during his planned trip to the U.S. at the end of this month for the G-20 Trade Ministerial. There are still 30 days before the U.S. can levy its tariffs. India's ability to secure a low rate will be a true test of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's friendship with Mr. Trump.

Antidote to drugs

The government must tighten the monitoring of drug production

With the recent bust of a counterfeit medicine racket in Bengaluru, a public policy issue with broad ramifications for health care in the State has emerged. Centered around Bengaluru, relabelled or fake drugs, including cancer drugs, injections used in the ICU, were supplied to more than 90 hospitals and clinics across the State. The lid was blown off this elaborate scam after incidental raids, near Bidadi in Karnataka on August 18, found suspected fake drugs and expired drugs at a farmhouse which was an unlicensed unit. The consignment had a label value of ₹5 crore. Investigators said that the farmhouse was used in an illicit drug operation – involving the repacking of fake and expired drugs as fresh consignments, with altered expiry dates, and as expensive, imported branded drugs – which were then sold at massive discounts. The State later formed a Special Investigation Team to trace the wider network. While exploring the distribution mechanism, investigators found that the network had been supplying these drugs to over 90 hospitals in the State, in cahoots with a pharmacy in Bengaluru, indicating that a network was thriving well before the bust. A few persons have been arrested and the police are on the tail of another who is not in the country at present. The impunity with which the scammers were operating is an indication of the unreliable scrutiny of the quality of drugs in the market. The biggest concern, however, is patient safety, given that these are drugs that can save lives and are marked out for time-sensitive usage. Also being examined are possible inter-State links, as investigators have launched a complete review of the supply chain. The illicit channels through which private hospitals bought and used these drugs, including possible complicity in the private hospital network, are under scrutiny.

With alarming regularity, issues to do with poor quality, spurious, fake or expired drugs hit the headlines in India. For a nation that zealously aspires to become the 'pharmacy of the world', India struggles to match its ambition with adequate and stringent monitoring and quality control systems. The question of drug quality is particularly significant as fake or spurious drugs can cause immediate adverse reactions, lead to severe disabilities, and even death. Recent incidents of contaminated cough syrups causing deaths, not only in India, but across the world, have further highlighted these woefully inadequate systems and consistently dented the pride of the "Make in India" campaign. Irrespective of whether India becomes the pharmacy of the world, there is a pressing need to make sure that drugs and medical supplies made in the country fulfil the highest quality standards.

When the first Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA) was passed in 1976, a government of a different political hue was in power from the one that has now proposed the more fierce FCRA Amendment Bill, 2026. But the underlying political apprehensions were similar – the fear that foreign powers could destabilise the country by funding civil society organisations (non-governmental organisations or NGOs). In the present case, there is also an unstated fear of religious conversions by Christian and other religious minorities. The Bill is yet to be enacted because of strong reactions by the Opposition parties and several civil society groups, particularly Christian organisations.

The government claims that the flow of foreign funds into India's NGO sector operates as a vast, intricate and opaque web. Under the banners of development, human rights and social welfare, thousands of crores of unmonitored capital pour into the country every year. Much of this money deliberately bypasses state accounting mechanisms and finds its way into politically charged campaigns, highly selective local advocacy, and aggressive proselytisation and religious conversion networks.

Proposed legislation, the concerns

Under the proposed legislation, if an FCRA certificate is cancelled, surrendered or automatically lapses, foreign contributions and all assets created from them would vest in a government-appointed "designated authority". The organisation can recover the assets if registration is restored within the prescribed period. Permanent vesting will occur only if registration is not restored within that period. The Bill also provides for revision and an appeal to the District Judge.

If a fresh certificate is not obtained within the prescribed period, the assets could be sold or transferred to a government department, with the proceeds going to the Consolidated Fund of India. However, during the provisional-vesting period, restoration of registration results in return of assets and unused foreign contribution.

NGOs, especially Christian organisations, which the government says receive a larger proportion of the funds among religions associations, are worried that the legislation may not be religion-neutral and that, ultimately, the real sufferers would be the beneficiaries served by such charitable organisations, which have established and operate numerous schools, hospitals, old-age care homes and similar institutions. As some leaders from the northeast and tribal areas have pointed out, such institutions are sometimes the largest or only providers of these services in many areas.

Already, the FCRA registrations of 22,496 NGOs



Pushpa Sundar

The author of several books on philanthropy, with the latest title being 'Giving with A Thousand Hands: The Changing Face of Indian Philanthropy'

India's non-governmental organisations must navigate shifting foreign and domestic funding sources

have been cancelled since 2015, leaving about 14,466 active registered associations eligible to receive foreign contributions (Ministry of Home Affairs data, September 2026). In fact, the amounts received are larger than those in 2006-07 (₹12,289.6 crore from private international donors), the last year for which data were available when this writer wrote the book, *Foreign Aid for Indian NGOs: Problem or Solution?* (2010).

So why the protests? The fact is that different sources of funding have a differential impact on organisations and their effectiveness because, as the saying goes, "He who pays the piper calls the tune".

Though in total, the volume of foreign aid to NGOs is small compared with government budgets, and only a small proportion of NGOs receive such aid, it is highly valued because it is not only an alternative source of funding but also more flexible than government funding, with fewer restrictions on how it can be used. It is generally tailored to an NGO's needs through discussions between the NGO and the donor.

The book, *Foreign Aid for Indian NGOs*, which is based desk research and interviews with several NGOs, large and small, suggests that while a few organisations felt that foreign aid had adverse consequences, such as encouraging the adoption of ideas and practices from abroad that were unsuited to Indian conditions, most felt that foreign funds had contributed to India's development and, in particular, to the growth of the voluntary sector. They had brought in new ideas, techniques, technologies and organisational improvements. In the absence of adequate government funding and private philanthropy, foreign aid had played a positive role.

Need for funding diversity

Today, however, given political events in neighbouring countries and elsewhere in the world, and without being privy to the secret sources of information that the government has about the destabilisation role played by foreign money, it is difficult to pass a definitive judgment on the need for and value of foreign aid today.

There can be no doubt that a vibrant and independent civil society is necessary for a healthy democracy and for preventing the abuse of unrestrained political power by any one section of society. Plural sources of funding are also necessary to ensure that civil society is not dependent on any one source.

But equally, one can question whether foreign funds are the only answer to the needs of civil society today. First, the voluntary sector is more developed now. Second, the situation regarding foreign aid itself has changed. Bona fide foreign donors are themselves moving away from giving

to India because of their own economic difficulties and the perception that India, which is aiming to become the world's third-largest economy, no longer needs aid from them.

Third, the domestic non-government funding environment has also improved. According to the Forbes 2026 list, there are 3,332 billionaires in the world, of whom 229 are in India, giving it the third-largest number after the United States and China. The amount they donate to philanthropy has also increased. According to the India Philanthropy Report by Bain & Company, private philanthropy was projected to reach ₹1.43 lakh crore (\$16 billion) in FY 2025. In addition, there is retail giving of about ₹37,000 crore annually.

The downside is that, according to the same report, demand is growing faster than supply, with projections indicating that the gap could reach ₹18 lakh crore (\$210 billion) by 2030.

Moreover, new philanthropists, especially entrepreneurs and technology leaders, are shifting away from traditional areas towards ecosystem building, scientific research, higher education and complex institutional support.

This is undoubtedly good news for social and economic change, but bad news for NGOs delivering traditional education, health and social welfare services.

A glimmer of hope for such NGOs is that, following the Companies Act, 2013, which made corporate social responsibility (CSR) spending compulsory for companies above a certain size, CSR spending by such listed companies was ₹22,563 crore in FY25, up 17.5% (latest CRISIL report).

Since many companies do not have the internal competency to undertake social development, they rely on NGOs as partners. Although many companies are moving into environmental and other emerging areas, many still find the traditional areas of health, education and rural development more meaningful.

A new opportunity

So if, in the ultimate analysis, the government does decide to limit foreign funding, the future need not be bleak if Indian domestic philanthropy steps up to fill the gap.

However, indigenous donors, and the government in particular, must become more responsive to the needs of NGOs, learn from foreign donors some of the practices that made their aid so sought after, and engage in more serious dialogue on funding practices, as distinct from development issues, to improve those practices and address the dissatisfaction on both sides. Ultimately, it is the innate generosity that is dormant in hundreds of dedicated Indians that will change the dynamics of development in India, not foreign aid, which at best can be the cherry on the cake.

India's real rate moment, the cost of delay

India is approaching an uncomfortable turning point in monetary policy. With the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) holding the repo rate at 5.25% while inflation rises, the real policy rate is steadily losing its cushion. Consumer price inflation rose to 4.82% in August, from 4.45% in July, marking the third consecutive month above the RBI's target of 4%. Food inflation is even higher at 5.95%. Core inflation has also risen to around 4.2%, suggesting that price pressures are broadening beyond food.

A view on the real interest rate is not obtained simply by subtracting yesterday's inflation from today's policy rate. Monetary policy operates through expected inflation. If the repo rate remains at 5.25% while inflation expectations move towards 5.25%, the ex-ante real policy rate becomes approximately zero. That is a very different monetary environment from the one in which the real policy rate is comfortably positive.

Closer to zero real rates

India is now much closer to that point than it appeared after the August policy. The RBI maintained a neutral stance, while projecting FY2026-27 inflation at around 5%. However, the latest inflation reading has moved beyond the RBI's projected average trajectory for the year: headline inflation is already 4.82%, while food inflation is 5.95%.

Therefore, if inflationary pressure maintains the current momentum and external pressure aggravates, India could soon find itself in a zero real interest rate environment.

The risks surrounding that trajectory are hardly trivial. The monsoon remains an important source of uncertainty. More importantly, India is confronting a potentially powerful external inflation shock. Renewed conflict in West Asia has disrupted shipping



Saumitra Bhaduri

Professor, Madras School of Economics

The Reserve Bank of India faces a shrinking real-rate cushion as inflation rises and demand remains strong

through the Strait of Hormuz and pushed Brent crude above \$100 a barrel, with prices approaching \$110. The combination of higher oil prices, a weaker rupee and elevated global commodity prices creates a substantially more difficult inflation environment.

Falling real rates are often thought to stimulate demand and credit when the economy is operating below capacity. However, when demand is already healthy, and the inflation shock originates from supply and expectations, the same mechanism can amplify rather than neutralise inflation.

Banking system trends

India's banking system makes the issue even more interesting because the zero real rate is not transmitted symmetrically to borrowers and savers. Bank credit growth stood at 19.1% year-on-year at the end of August and remains exceptionally strong.

Deposits, however, have also surged. Deposit growth reached 17.8% at the end of August, the fastest pace in a decade, partly because of the RBI's special FCNR(B) mobilisation scheme. The increase therefore needs careful interpretation: it does not necessarily indicate that domestic households have suddenly become more willing to hold conventional bank deposits. Instead, much of the increase reflects foreign currency inflows under the special scheme. The credit-deposit ratio was around 80.3% at the end of August.

India is consequently experiencing strong credit demand even as banks compete for stable domestic deposits. Households increasingly have alternatives to bank deposits, including mutual funds and equities. When inflation rises, the real return on conventional deposits becomes less attractive, giving savers a greater incentive to

move towards market-linked assets, gold or other inflation hedges. Empirical evidence from India underscores the importance of this channel. RBI research on the earlier inflation episode found that rising inflation and inflation expectations reduced the real return on household financial savings. During the high-inflation period from 2010 to 2013, real returns on savings instruments became negative and household financial savings weakened, while demand for gold increased substantially. The correlation between gold imports and household inflation expectations was estimated at 0.83 over the period studied.

Therefore, did the RBI miss an opportunity to react earlier? A central bank should not raise rates simply because oil prices have increased. Yet, it must consider the risk that temporary inflation becomes embedded in expectations, wages, prices and credit.

That risk now looks more real. Inflation has remained above 4% for three consecutive months, and August's 4.82% reading was accompanied by a rise in core inflation to around 4.2%, while the one-year OIS rate is around 6%, signalling expectations of some future tightening. At the same time, GDP growth is running at 7.8%, and bank credit is growing at 19.1%. Demand is hardly weak.

The issue is about timing

A 5.25% repo rate may therefore appear restrictive in nominal terms, but offers increasingly little restraint in real terms. The real issue, therefore, is timing. In monetary policy, timing is an instrument in itself. A timely 25-basis-point adjustment may ultimately cost less than a delayed 50-basis-point correction. Importantly, the direction is clear – inflation is moving toward the policy rate while growth and credit remain strong. Perhaps the time has come.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Climate action

India's lower per-capita emissions and progress on renewable capacity are significant, but climate responsibility cannot be discussed only through present-day averages (Front page, September 20). India's rising energy demand, urbanisation and industrial growth require a credible transition strategy. Greater investment in green public transport, energy-efficient buildings, storage technologies and

decentralised renewable power can reduce emissions. In addition, developed countries should provide predictable climate finance and technology access. In the end, a practical approach should combine equity, accountability and measurable targets, rather than competing narratives.

A. Myilsami,
Coimbatore

The real test

A 'bloated' medal tally at

the Asian Games is fine, but it can also create an illusion of sporting progress when several events lack Olympic-level depth. The real test remains the Olympics, where India's performance has repeatedly exposed the gap between regional dominance and global competitiveness. Celebrate medals, certainly, but measure sporting progress by performance against the world's best.

Harsh Pawaria,
Rohtak, Haryana

Immersions and lakes

I wish to highlight the severe environmental toll after idol immersions in Bengaluru's water bodies. The annual immersion of thousands of idols made of Plaster of Paris and painted with synthetic colours releases heavy metals such as lead and mercury into lakes. This can poison aquatic life, damage local flora and fauna, and introduce toxic substances into the human food chain through bioaccumulation,

posing serious health risks. Tradition and nature need not be in conflict. Citizens and organisers must consciously shift to natural clay idols and non-toxic colours to ensure that our celebrations preserve rather than pollute the environment.

Sowmiya Devi Rammohan,
Bengaluru

Dumping festival idols into our local lakes is getting out of hand. These huge structures are covered in

toxic chemical paints and made of Plaster of Paris, which pollutes the water. If we want to save our shrinking lakes and water bodies, the government must completely ban chemical paints and non-biodegradable materials. Our celebrations should not end up destroying the environment.

Shreshya Bhardwaj,
Bengaluru

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Campaign to reduce the intake of salt

Salt, as an essential electrolyte, sits at the centre of human well-being, but being most prone to overuse and misuse, the condiment remains at the heart of illness as well. When Tamil Nadu Health Minister K.G. Arunraj took salt to the floor of the Assembly, he dragged it willy-nilly into public discourse. He announced plans to launch a multi-pronged mission to reduce salt intake, turning attention to the right quantities and forms that must be consumed. The Minister's speech made it clear that the government's plans were not merely about a dietary tweak, but instead, a recalibration of how well-being is perceived.

Salt, in the right proportions, facilitates hydration, nerve signalling, muscle function, digestion and also has a role to play in stress physiology. However, in excess, or in ultra processed foods, it can have a deleterious impact on health, increasing the risk of stroke, heart disease and kidney strain over time.

Surveys by the Indian Council of Medical Research show that in India, men consume an average of 8.9 gms daily, while women consume about 7.1 gms. The WHO, which recommends keeping the intake under 5 gms of salt per day, released a set of guidelines in January 2025, recommending the use of lower-sodium salt substitutes.

In Tamil Nadu, hypertension is a major public health concern. A 2024 study by Selvavinayagam T.S. et al showed that adult prevalence of hypertension in Tamil Nadu hovered around 33.9 %, much above



Ramya Kannan

the national average of 28.5 %. There is a direct link between consuming excess salt and hypertension – consuming too much salt causes the body to retain extra water, which increases blood volume and puts higher pressure on the artery walls, leading to clinical hypertension.

Action plan

The State government's plan is comprehensive. For the first time, a Statewide survey using urine samples will scientifically measure salt consumption. Salt will be gradually reduced in government-run kitchens, including the Nutritious Meal Programme, ICDS centres, government hospitals and hostels. The feasibility of introducing a low-sodium salt substitute will be examined. This will be backed by a State-wide awareness campaign on how to read labels on packages, tasting before adding salt, and using natural flavour enhancers. Researchers of a randomised, double-blind, controlled trial reported in the *American Journal of Clinical Nutrition* in 2021, wrote that replacing salt with a reduced-sodium, added-potassium salt substitute is an acceptable and effective dietary intervention for lowering systolic blood pressure in persons with hypertension in rural India.

The State also intends to step up its hypertension control activities through its community health outreach programme Makkalai Thedi Maruthuvam and other public health care institutions. People diagnosed with hypertension will receive systematic counselling and anti-hypertension drugs.

Cutting down salt is a simple change that can make a major difference to cardiovascular health — less salt today can mean lower blood pressure, fewer heart attacks, and fewer strokes tomorrow

There is evidence that such closely-monitored health interventions succeed.

The Sapiens Health Foundation has welcomed the new salt reduction campaign of the Tamil Nadu government. Its founder Rajan Ravichandran says, “This is a wonderful surprise, we have been knocking at many doors to bring in awareness of salt reduction in the public health sector. It can be very powerful in changing the way people consume salt. We just have to go back to 2005, where the campaign initiated by Graham MacGregor of the World Action on Salt, Sugar and Health, resulted in a reported 30% reduction of salt in bread, in the U.K.”.

G. Sengottuvelu, senior interventional cardiologist, Apollo Hospitals, explains further, “Excess salt is one of the most important and preventable contributors to high blood pressure, heart attack and stroke.” His argument is that Indians' preference for salty food is largely an acquired habit, often beginning in childhood, and the palate can adapt when salt is gradually reduced. Cutting down salt is a simple change that can make a major difference to cardiovascular health — less salt today can mean lower blood pressure, fewer heart attacks, and fewer strokes tomorrow.

As Tamil Nadu rolls out its programme, hopefully with scientific vigour and cultural sensitivity, other States will do well to watch and emulate. If it is possible to cut down hypertension, cardiovascular disease, and kidney disease with adjusting the size of a single pinch, then, why not?

ramya.kannan@thehindu.co.in

Missing measure in India's magnet mission

Most Indians know the parable of several blind men trying to describe an elephant. One touches its trunk and believes it is a snake. Another feels its leg and insists it is a pillar. None is entirely wrong, yet none sees the whole animal.

India's strategy for advancing its cutting-edge technologies, aimed at becoming a global manufacturing leader, carries the risk of making a similar mistake. From EV motors and semiconductor fabrication facilities to precision manufacturing machineries, at the heart of each lies an unassuming component: the high-performance permanent magnet. They serve as the silent operating system of industrial acceleration.

Magnets are not all the same. Ferrite, Alnico and Samarium-Cobalt magnets continue to serve important industrial applications. Yet Neodymium-Iron-Boron (NdFeB) magnets have become the backbone of energy transition and advanced manufacturing because no other commercially available permanent magnet combines comparable magnetic strength with such a high power-to-weight ratio. Recognising its importance, India has begun strengthening its critical minerals and rare earth element strategy through initiatives such as the National Critical Mineral Mission, overseas mineral acquisitions, expanded geological exploration, and PLI schemes.

However, China's tight export controls on rare-earth magnets and materials in April 2025 not only revealed the

Suvajit Banerjee
Fellow at the National Council of Applied Economic Research (NCAER), New Delhi in the research vertical of Computable General Equilibrium Modelling and Policy Analysis. Views are personal

Sovini Mondal

Research Analyst at the NCAER in the research vertical of Computable General Equilibrium Modelling and Policy Analysis. Views are personal

Sanjib Pohit

Professor and Thematic Lead at the NCAER in the research vertical of Computable General Equilibrium Modelling and Policy Analysis. Views are personal

The strategic question is not simply whether India possesses rare-earth resources or whether imports from China can be reduced. The real policy challenge is understanding what happens in between

deep-seated vulnerabilities in global industrial value chains, but also the limits of our understanding. For India, the primary vulnerability does not stem from a shortage of critical minerals; rather, it lies in the absence of a comprehensive framework to pinpoint where strategic technological dependence is cultivated, accumulated and propagated throughout the permanent magnet value chain.

The journey of a magnet

Consider a simple example. India's Annual Survey of Industries estimates the domestic permanent magnet market at around ₹750 crore. Yet international trade statistics indicate import values several times larger than that entire reported market. The gap may reflect differences in statistical coverage, industrial classification or supply-chain accounting. Whatever the explanation, policymakers face a troubling reality: they cannot confidently explain where all these magnets enter the economy or how they move through it. In other words, parts of India's permanent magnet economy appear to exist without being fully visible in statistics.

Unlike other products, permanent magnets pass through a long technological journey. Geological exploration leads to mining. Mining feeds mineral processing. Processing enables chemical separation. Separation produces oxides, which are refined into metals, transformed into alloys, engineered into magnetic materials, and finally manufactured into finished magnets. Each stage demands different scientific knowledge, industrial capability and technological maturity. This is why

discussions on critical minerals frequently miss the real point. The strategic question is not simply whether India possesses rare-earth resources or whether imports from China can be reduced. The real policy challenge is understanding what happens in between.

Although India has developed capabilities across several stages of permanent magnet manufacturing, the country still lacks a systematic way of identifying where those capabilities are globally competitive, where critical gaps persist, and how dependence accumulates across production stages. India's statistical system provides only a partial picture of what is mined, imported, manufactured.

One way to bridge this gap is through an Integrated Techno-Economic Mapping (ITEM) framework which presently is a missing piece in India's industrial policy toolkit. Such a framework brings together information on engineering and economic measurement to show how a permanent magnet is built, from minerals in the ground to the finished products that power advanced manufacturing. More importantly, it would identify where industrial capability should be built, where technological partnerships become essential, and where domestic investment would yield the greatest strategic return. A country may secure mineral resources yet remain dependent if it lacks processing and manufacturing capabilities. Bridging this measurement gap is not an academic exercise; it is an industrial imperative.

The paradox of self-reliance: India-China trade dynamics

While India is steadily building its manufacturing capabilities, that expansion remains deeply embedded in China-centric, import-dependent supply chains

DATA POINT

Surendar Singh

After the bilateral meeting between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping on the sidelines of the BRICS summit in Delhi on September 12, India said the two leaders had underlined the need to address each other's concerns, including “structural trade imbalance and supply chain issues”. This assumes significance as the widening trade deficit with China reveals a central paradox in India's ambitious Atmanirbhar Bharat mission to bolster domestic manufacturing and reduce dependence on global supply chains, with China as the implicit target.

India is steadily building its manufacturing and export capabilities. However, that expansion remains deeply embedded in China-centric, import-dependent supply chains – creating what may be called the “assembly trap” of self-reliance. Bilateral trade touched \$167.6 billion in 2025 but has become asymmetric, with imports from China rising much faster than India's exports (Chart 1).

Exports to China remained broadly stagnant between 2021 and 2025, while imports rose sharply by about 71% from \$87.5 billion to \$149.5 billion in the same period – highlighting persistent structural weaknesses in India's manufacturing and trade competitiveness. Nearly 70% of India's imports from China are intermediate goods and another 22% capital goods (Chart 2). This composition shows that the India-China trade deficit is not simply a consequence of Indian consumers buying Chinese finished products. It reflects deeper structural asymmetries in manufacturing capability and technological dependence, with India's reliance on Chinese supply chains extending into the manufacturing system as inputs, components and semi-processed goods.

The trends in India's top five import categories from China between 2021 and 2025 (Table 1) reveal that this reliance has deepened rather than diversified, despite initiatives such as Make in India and the Phased Manufacturing Programme (PMP). The combined value of the top five categories of imports rose from \$19 billion in 2021 to \$34.6 billion in 2025 – close to one-fourth of total imports from China, showing that India's import basket has become more concentrated in a few electronics-related categories. That telecom equipment, laptops and integrated circuits remain in the top five shows that India's electronics assembly is still structurally exposed to Chinese supply chains.

India has emerged as a major hub for mobile phone assembly, but the share of imported parts and components has risen sharply from 3.3% of the import basket in 2022 to 10.1% in 2025 (Chart 3) – revealing the contradiction in that success story: it has been shaped, at least so far, by downstream assembly rather than by a deep domestic component ecosystem.

Imports of sophisticated inputs and capital goods can facilitate industrial upgrading, but they become problematic when the dependence turns structurally persistent and domestic firms fail to build capability in semiconductors and other precision components. In order to resolve such structural and capability challenges, the focus must shift from incentivising assembly to building domestic technological capability, innovation, supplier networks and component ecosystems. The response should not be blanket restrictions but calibrated tariffs on parts and components, designed to nurture segments of domestic manufacturing value chains.

India should focus on enhancing access to global value chains while building domestic capabilities, so that critical technological dependencies do not harden into strategic vulnerabilities.

Structural asymmetry

The data for the charts were sourced from the World Integrated Trade Solution (WITS), developed by the World Bank in collaboration with the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD). Surendar Singh is an Associate Professor at O.P. Jindal Global University, Sonapat. Views expressed in this article are personal



CHART 1: India's exports to China has remained broadly stagnant between 2021-2025, while imports rose sharply from \$87.5 billion to \$149.5 billion in the same period, resulting in the widening trade deficit

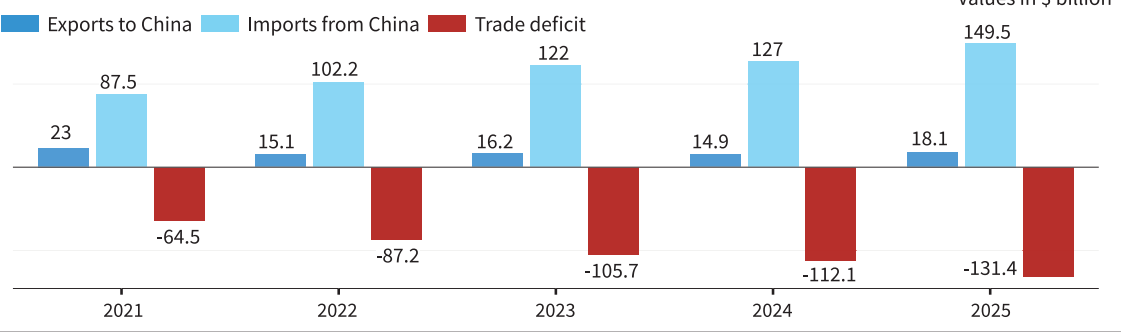


CHART 2: Intermediate and capital goods accounted for the major share of different categories of India's imports from China in 2025, as shown in this chart

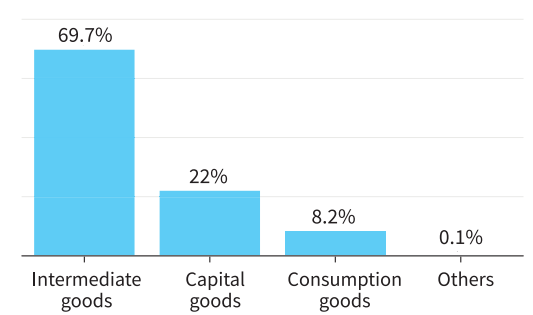


CHART 3: The share of India's imports of components, used for manufacturing mobile phones, from China has risen

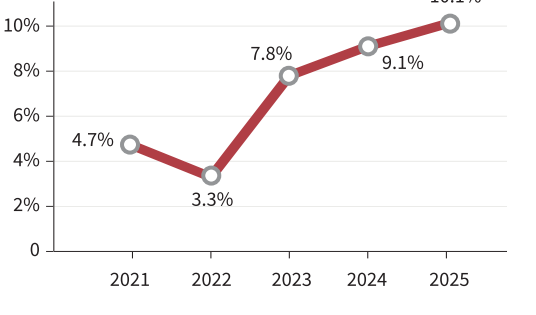


TABLE 1: India's import basket from China has been persistently concentrated in a few electronics-related categories rather than becoming more diversified over the years, indicating India's continued reliance on China for its manufacturing

India's top five imports from China (\$ billion)				
Year	Total imports (\$ bn)	Product groups	Top five imports (\$bn)	Share
2021	87.5	Laptops, telecom parts, LED/solar cells, ICs and transmission	19.0	21.7%
2022	102.2	Laptops, ICs, Telecom parts and Li-ion batteries	19.0	18.6%
2023	122.0	Telecom parts, ICs, laptops, LED/solar cells and mobile phones	26.3	21.5%
2024	127.0	Telecom parts, laptops, ICs, LED/solar cells and mobile phones	29.5	23.3%
2025	149.5	Telecom parts, laptops, ICs, mobile phones and silver	34.6	23.2%

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 21, 1976

Toothpaste quality to be ensured

New Delhi, September 20: Leading manufacturers of toothpastes and other toilet goods agreed to-day to apply for certification by the Indian Standards Institution to ensure the quality of their products.

They also assured the Union Minister of State for Civil Supplies and Co-operation, Mr. A. C. George, that they would within a short time make their suggestions about a machinery which could deal with the pricing of these products.

Mr. George had a meeting here with senior functionaries of the All-India Soap and Toiletries Makers' Association, which represents manufacturers of toothpastes, soaps, cosmetics, perfumes, etc. in the organised sector.

Later, speaking to newsmen, Mr. George said there was a crisis of confidence among consumers over the claims made by manufacturers of toothpastes, etc. about the quality of their products.

The packaging of these products often created an optical illusion about their content. Misleading claims were made in advertisements and their prices were sometimes unduly high.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 21, 1926

Four persons attempting to cross Channel

Rugby, September 20: No less than 4 persons are or have been trying to swim the Channel to-day. They are all British. Miss Mona MacLellan and Mister Horace Carey entered the water at Cape Grisnez at 5:30 yesterday evening.

Colonel Freyberg who won the Victoria Cross made his third effort leaving Cape Grisnez at 5:30 this morning. Miss Marriott is starting from Cape Grisnez this evening.

Colonel Freyberg gave up his attempt when about seven miles from Dover owing to his position being unfavourable. He had been in water ten hours. This evening there was some excitement in Dover when a motor-boat accompanying Miss MacLellan and Horace Carey was sighted about a mile off the Dover Pier proceeding in a westerly direction. Apparently there was only one person in water but it was impossible to ascertain whether the swimmer was Miss MacLellan or Carey.

CM
YK

Kurmish will be kept outside the ambit of UCC, says Suvendu

Indian Army's military dogs, including indigenous Rampur Hounds, are showcasing their specialised operational skills alongside U.S. Army personnel during the ongoing India-U.S. bilateral exercise Yudh Abhyas 2026. According to the Indian Army, four Army Canines - Rampur Hounds Victor and Rowdy, Belgian Malinois Zac and Labrador Retriever Rice are participating in the exercise, demonstrating their capabilities in room intervention and rappelling drills as part of the professional exchanges with the U.S. Army. Rampur Hounds are increasingly being inducted for specialised military roles. Its participation in the exercise highlights Army's efforts to employ indigenous canine breeds for operational tasks.

Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) have turned cautious again, pulling out ₹20,974 crore from Indian equities so far in September amid global uncertainties, higher U.S. interest rates and bond yields, elevated crude oil prices and a weakening rupee. The latest outflow comes after foreign investors returned to Indian equities in July and August, when they invested ₹20,200 crore and ₹29,630 crore, respectively, according to data from CDSL. With the September selling, FPIs have now withdrawn a total of ₹2.45 lakh crore from Indian equities so far in 2026, surpassing the ₹1.66 lakh crore outflow recorded during the entire 2025. ^{PTI}

Vidura's dharma sukshma

After the Pandavas leave for the forest, Dhritarashtra is uneasy, and seeks Vidura's advice, said Kidambi Narayanan in a discourse. He says Vidura knows dharma sukshma. Dharma sukshma goes beyond merely knowing the rules. It means a person knows how to react in a particular situation, how to analyse a situation and come to the right conclusion. Only those with experience in dealing with problems of various kinds will have dharma sukshma. Dhritarashtra is aware that Vidura has jnana, which includes knowledge of dharma too. Dhritarashtra is worried. He knows his family cannot get away unhurt if they hurt the Pandavas. Not only will they have to face the wrath of the Pandavas, but will have to deal with the displeasure of the people too. He tells Vidura that whatever Sakuni did was for the welfare of Duryodhana. But he knows that dharma was not adhered to in his court. He asks Vidura how to atone for what happened in the royal assembly.

Vidura says seeking wealth and pleasures must be within the boundaries of dharma. The foundation of governance is dharma. Dhritarashtra must not only be keen to protect his sons, but must also want to protect the Pandavas. "You are prejudiced against the Pandavas. You must come out of this mindset. A king should not covet other people's wealth. At least from now on, stop troubling the Pandavas. If the Kauravas continue to torment the Pandavas, your family will be destroyed. The Pandavas should be brought back. Yudhishtira is not ambitious. A kingdom will be safe only in the hands of such a king," Vidura tells Dhritarashtra.

India’s UPI moment for insurance

Sarbvir Singh

UPI is hailed as a landmark in India’s digital public infrastructure journey as it created an interoperable system allowing an entire market to function differently. The recent consultation paper on Public Insurance Registry by IRDAI has the potential to spark a similar revolution in insurance giving an opportunity to tackle information gap via a common and trusted layer of information across the ecosystem. IRDAI laid down a roadmap with design principles, a legal anchor, a governance model and a phased implementation.

Why DPI, why now? Insurance is still one of the last large financial sectors where policies are not accessible at a single point. Formalities such as KYC have to be done multiple times. Claims history is not easily available as it should be. Besides, consumer awareness and product comparisons still depend on a salesperson’s narrative than verified information. The consultation paper moves the sector from the old adage that “insurance is sold” to a world where “insurance is also bought.” While Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha Act gives IRDAI a statutory anchor for insurance digitisation, the Digital Personal Data Protection Act provides data privacy while Bima Sugam boosts accessibility. But a connective tissue making them a unified framework was still missing which is what PIR is.

What makes design credible The paper not only borrows the language of DPI but also discipline. Its design principles are from India’s G20 Task Force on DPI – interoperable but not uniform. It has minimalist building blocks and a federated architecture with source-system primacy to ensure data stays where it is collected and not centralised. In its proposal, Public Insurance Registry positions itself as common information layer that lets participants discover, verify and exchange insurance information consistently. With the free flow of information, the competitive advantage shifts to innovation and customer experience. Every stakeholder, including insurers and customers, has a shared role in making ecosystem more transparent. In this regard, the governance proposal to restructure the Insurance Information Bureau (IIB) into a not-for-profit firm wholly owned by IRDAI is a critical step. With independent execution, institutional neutrality and rotating industry representation on board, it ensures PIR gains statutory legitimacy without regulatory capture. A phased rollout will focus on early, visible wins rather than an all-out sweeping mandate.

In practice For the policyholder, PIR promises a consolidated view of every policy across life, health, motor and property. It has nominees, renewals, claims and unclaimed benefits visible in one place and portability turns real. Linkages with VAHAN and e-DAR can cut motor claim settlement and disputes. While insurers get verified policy and claims history to improve underwriting and fraud control, standardised reporting cuts compliance cost. For reinsurers and IRDAI, aggregate exposure data boosts catastrophe preparedness and oversight. For banks and government, verified coverage data leads to credit and better-targeted welfare. Above all, PIR gives the ecosystem what it always lacked – a shared, authoritative view of who is insured, for what and how well they are served.

A moment to seize At Policybazaar, we know first-hand how much friction fragmented information creates for customers and the industry. PIR addresses the friction at its root. UPI transformed how India pays. PIR can transform how India protects itself. The industry must welcome and adopt it wholeheartedly and make it a success. *(The writer is Joint Group CEO, PB Fintech)*



ILLUSTRATION: SAAI

In insurance, the written word means everything

When you take an insurance policy, don’t go by the “leave the paperwork to us” pitch. It’s your money and your family’s financial well-being. Give the paperwork the diligence it deserves

BETWEEN THE LINES

K. Nitya Kalyani

Did your insurance agent or the broker just say, “Sir, you just sign the proposal form, I will take care of filling it”? And, did you say “yes”? It’s a wrong move. If the intermediary, by mistake or deliberately, fills in erroneous information, you may still be the person answering for it. You signed the proposal form and the consequences, logical or legal, can be yours. It could be an error in your address or phone number, or a pre-existing disease deliberately concealed to hasten or smoothen policy issuance. You are the one who will live with the consequences. Your renewal notices may not reach you or your claim could be rejected.

Basic caution Drastic? No. It’s basic caution that you should read something related to a critical financial decision and outlay that you are going to sign. The next time you take a life or health insurance policy, don’t go by the “leave the paperwork to us” pitch. It’s your health, your life, your money and your family’s financial well-being. Give the paperwork the diligence it deserves. Read it. Check it. Then, sign it.



“Just sign it, I’ll fill it in.” And if you say yes it is a wrong move you have made. What goes into the proposal form can come back to you later, especially when a claim or other dispute arises



What was promised orally across the table may be forgotten. What is written in the policy is harder to argue with when you need to establish what you were promised

Another error to avoid is going along with anyone who says, “Sir, we need not declare that you have high blood pressure in the proposal form. Policy will be delayed or they will charge higher premium...” Both may be true.

Cost of concealment However, every equation has two sides and that is where simple money mathematics comes in. A higher premium for the appropriate cover after you have made full disclosure is cheaper than a repudiated claim when you have spent a few lakhs at a hospital. Then, there is simple time mathematics. Any insurance policy is a commitment you make as part of your long-term life plans. The time you spend filling up or at least checking the proposal form before signing it is an investment of your time, not a waste of it.

Talk evaporates In this case, the intermediary is telling you to make a false declaration of facts. It may be a misguided

move to help you and help himself but the problem is that his advice is only oral. That makes it very difficult to establish later if there is a dispute. The same goes for oral marketing pitches stating what is covered, the terms and conditions of the policy or the returns on an insurance-and-investment product such as a unit-linked insurance policy. What you are told may help you decide. What you sign and what the policy says may determine what happens later. So, check that important assurances you were given are supported by the policy documents. For example, if you are told there are no sub-limits in your policy, check the policy wordings. If you are told that some procedures are covered only after 24 months, read the list in the policy documents and confirm that it is indeed 24 and not 36 months. If there is a discrepancy, raise it with your insurer and agent immediately. I am sure I don’t have to say ‘in writing!’ But what if you discover

the problem only after the policy is in hand? That is where the free-look period can give you a second opportunity to re-view your decision. IRDAI regulations provide a 30-day free-look period for eligible life and health insurance policies, from receipt of the policy document. During this time you can review it. If you see discrepancies between what you heard and what you have got, if you have second thoughts about its suitability or your affordability or even if you have just changed your mind, you can make a written cancel request for the policy and get a refund subject to the rules. The free-look cancellation is not a magic cure for every wrong decision or every instance of mis-selling. But it gives you a valuable window to read what you bought, compare it with what you thought you were buying and act if the two do not match. Insurance is a product with enormous benefits. But when two parties to a contract don’t have the same level of information, trust can break down. Which is why you, as a customer, have to be more diligent. What you are told may help you decide. What you sign and what the policy says may determine what happens later. Read. Check. And learn to read between the lines.

(The writer is a business journalist specialising in insurance & corporate history)

ETFs vs. index funds

THINKINVESTOR

Your choice of benchmark must be the large-cap index or the broadest investable index for institutional investors in the market where you can make goal-based investments

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

Suppose you decide to invest in passive funds for your goal-based investments. You must first select a benchmark index and then choose an exchange-traded fund (ETF) or an index fund on that benchmark index. In this article, we discuss the factors that you must consider when deciding between an ETF and an index fund.

Total costs Your choice of benchmark must be the large-cap index or the broadest investable index for institutional investors in the market where you make such goal-based investments. Take the NSE 500 Index. This index also contains mid-cap and small-cap stocks that can expose you to momentum crash. That means these stocks can crash regardless of the direction of the market. This makes the choice of the broadest index somewhat risky for goal-based investments. Suppose you choose a large-cap index. Then, you must decide whether to pick an ETF or an index fund benchmarked to that index. If you consider the base expense ratio (BER), an ETF is cheaper than an index fund; median BER for an index fund is 0.15% compared with 0.08% for an ETF. But there are other costs to consider. You must setup a systematic investment plan (SIP) on an ETF through your trading account. You can set up the SIP with market protection to ensure that your order is not executed at a price significantly greater than its last traded price. If you are setting up the SIP for the number of units, then the amount debited each month will be different. If you set up the SIP for the amount, then you may have residual amount in your account, as you cannot buy fractional units. Suppose the ETF price is ₹61, and your SIP is for ₹10,000. Then, you will get 163 units, and ₹57 will remain in your trading account. You will also incur demat charges and other costs such as SEBI turnover fees, brokerage commission and exchange transaction fees including GST. Index funds can allot fractional units. So, you can make use of your entire SIP amount. Also, you will not incur the other transaction charges.

Conclusion The choice between an ETF and an index fund is more of preference than of cost. Note that ETFs can be sold real-time in the market, and the money is credited into your bank account the next day. You must wait at least two days to receive the sale proceeds on your index funds. *(The author offers training programs for individuals to manage their personal investments)*

Bank Fixed Deposit Rates

Bank Name	Interest Rates (%)			
	Highest Slab	1-year Tenure	3-year Tenure	5-year Tenure
Small Finance Banks				
AU Small Finance Bank	7.40	6.35	7.40	6.75
Equitas Small Finance Bank	8.00	7.10	7.10	7.00
ESAF Small Finance Bank	8.00	6.00	6.00	5.75
Jana Small Finance Bank	8.00	7.00	8.00	7.77
Shivalik Small Finance Bank	8.00	6.00	7.50	6.25
slice Small Finance Bank	7.75	6.25	7.50	7.00
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	8.25	7.25	7.25	8.25
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	7.80	7.25	7.25	7.20
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	8.10	6.00	7.50	7.00
Private Sector Banks				
Axis Bank	6.50	6.25	6.50	6.50
Bandhan Bank	7.45	7.00	7.25	5.85
City Union Bank	7.25	6.65	6.50	6.55
CSB Bank	7.10	5.00	5.75	5.75
DBS Bank	6.85	6.30	6.40	6.25
DCB Bank	7.50	6.90	7.00	7.50
Federal Bank	6.70	6.25	6.50	6.40
HDFC Bank	6.50	6.25	6.45	6.40
ICICI Bank	6.50	6.25	6.45	6.50
IDFC FIRST Bank	7.10	6.50	7.10	6.75
IndusInd Bank	7.00	6.75	7.00	6.65

Bank Name	Interest Rates (%)			
	Highest Slab	1-year Tenure	3-year Tenure	5-year Tenure
Public Sector Banks				
Jammu & Kashmir Bank	7.05	6.55	6.70	6.75
IDBI Bank	6.50	6.20	6.35	6.25
Karnataka Bank	7.00	6.50	6.15	6.15
Kotak Mahindra Bank	6.80	6.35	6.40	6.25
RBL Bank	7.20	7.00	7.20	6.70
SBM Bank India	7.30	7.10	7.10	7.00
South Indian Bank	6.80	6.25	6.20	5.70
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.25	6.80	6.70	6.70
YES Bank	7.25	6.65	7.00	6.75
Public Sector Banks				
Bank of Baroda	6.75	6.25	6.25	6.30
Bank of India	6.85	6.50	6.70	6.00
Bank of Maharashtra	6.65	6.40	5.25	5.00
Canara Bank	6.60	6.25	6.25	6.25
Central Bank of India	6.75	6.10	6.00	6.00
Indian Bank	6.65	6.10	6.05	6.00
Indian Overseas Bank	6.60	6.50	6.10	6.10
Punjab National Bank	6.60	6.25	6.30	6.35
Punjab & Sind Bank	6.85	5.85	5.85	5.95
State Bank of India	6.45	6.25	6.30	6.05
Union Bank of India	6.55	6.20	6.10	6.00

Home Loan Interest Rates

Name of Lender	Loan Amount (Rs.)		
	Upto 30 lakh	Above 30 lakh & upto 75 lakh	Above 75 lakh
(In %)			
Public Sector Banks			
Bank of Baroda	7.20-9.00	7.20-9.00	7.20-9.25
Bank of India	7.10-10.00	7.10-10.00	7.10-10.25
Bank of Maharashtra	7.00-9.90	7.00-9.90	7.00-9.90
Central Bank of India	7.00-9.15	7.00-9.15	7.00-9.15
Indian Bank	7.15-9.15	7.15-9.15	7.15-9.15
Indian Overseas Bank	7.20 #	7.20 #	7.20 #
Punjab and Sind Bank	7.35-10.75	7.35-10.75	7.35-10.75
Punjab National Bank	7.30-9.30	7.25-9.20	7.25-9.20
State Bank of India	7.25-8.55	7.25-8.55	7.25-8.55
Union Bank of India*	7.15-9.60	7.15-9.60	7.15-9.60
Private Sector Banks			
Axis Bank	8.00-11.90	8.00-11.90	8.00 - 9.10
Bandhan Bank	8.55 - 13.52	8.55 - 13.52	8.55 - 13.52
City Union Bank	8.25-9.50	8.50-10.00	8.75-10.50
CSB Bank	8.30 #	8.30 #	8.30 #
Federal Bank	8.35 - 10.50	7.35 - 10.50	7.35 - 9.50
HDFC Bank	7.75 #	7.75 #	7.75 #
HSBC Bank	7.45 #	7.45 #	7.45 #
ICICI Bank	7.55 #	7.55 #	7.55 #

Name of Lender	Loan Amount (Rs.)		
	Upto 30 lakh	Above 30 lakh & upto 75 lakh	Above 75 lakh
(In %)			
Public Sector Banks			
Karnataka Bank	7.48-11.80	7.48-11.80	7.48-11.80
Karur Vysya Bank	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65
Kotak Mahindra Bank	7.60 #	7.60 #	7.60 #
RBL Bank	9.00 #	9.00 #	9.00 #
South Indian Bank	7.25 #	7.25 #	7.25 #
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.90 - 9.30	7.90 - 9.30	7.90 - 9.30
Housing Finance Companies (HFCs)			
Aditya Birla Capital	7.75 #	7.75 #	7.75 #
Bajaj Housing Finance	7.25 #	7.25 #	7.25 #
GIC Housing Finance	8.20 #	8.20 #	8.20 #
Godrej Housing Finance	7.65 #	7.65 #	7.65 #
ICICI Home Finance	7.50 #	7.50 #	7.50 #
LIC Housing Finance	7.15 #	7.15 #	7.15 #
PNB Housing Finance	7.75-10.05#	7.60-10.05#	7.50-9.95
Sammaan Capital	8.75 #	8.75 #	8.75 #
SMFG India Home Finance	9.25 #	9.25 #	9.25 #
Tata Capital	8.00 #	8.00 #	8.00 #
*Extra interest rate concession of 0.05% to borrowers opting for insurance policy Rates as on September 16 #onwards Source:Paisabazaar.com			

Send queries on personal finance and investing to the moneywise@thehindu.co.in ID. Our experts in personal finance will respond to select queries, but will not give specific recommendations for investment in a particular mutual fund, share or fixed deposit.

STRONG START

Suchika assured of bronze medal in Traditional MMA 60kg event



FILE PHOTO

Suchika Tariyal assured India of another medal at the Asian Games, beating Mongolia's Altanchimeg Baigalmaa 2-0 to enter the semifinals of the women's Traditional Mixed Martial Arts 60kg event on Sunday. The semifinals at the Nagoya City Inae Sports Centre on Monday will give Suchika a chance to turn her bronze into a gold.

TOPPING THE CHARTS

Smriti becomes highest run-getter in the history of women's T20Is



FILE PHOTO

India opener Smriti Mandhana became the leading run-scorer in women's T20Is during the Asian Games semifinal against Bangladesh at Nisshin on Sunday. The elegant left-hander, who made a 19-ball 37, surpassed New Zealand great Suzie Bates' tally (4,758). She has an aggregate of 4,788 from 178 matches.

SO NEAR YET SO FAR

Quimcy narrowly misses bronze as India suffers double heartbreak



X@ANI_DIGITAL

India's Quimcy Dsouza lost both her bronze-medal matches in teqball at the Asian Games in Nagoya. Quimcy went down fighting to Japan's Yuina Sakamoto 11-12, 11-12 in women's singles. The Quimcy-Mohamed Anas Beg pair lost 9-12, 6-12 to Vietnam's Hoang Minh Tan Nguyen and Gia Nghinh Trinh in mixed doubles.

MAKING A SPLASH

Teen sensation Yu breaks record as China dominates swimming



REUTERS

Thirteen-year-old Yu Zidi announced herself at the Asian Games in style as the Chinese swimmers dominated the opening day of the competition being held in Tokyo. Olympic champion Pan Zhanle topped the podium as China triumphed in six of the seven finals. Yu won women's 200m butterfly with a Games record of 2:05.08s.

Elavenil stars as shooters clinch two silver medals

The senior markswoman squanders a comfortable lead to finish behind host Japan's Tanichi in 10m air rifle after opening India's account in the team event along with Sonam and Vidarsa

ASIAN GAMES

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Till the midway stage, Elavenil Valarivan was placed comfortably at the top with a lead that would, on any other day, be enough to keep her there till the end. On Sunday, Elavenil, the seniormost of the three Indian women in the 10m air rifle competition here, allowed her mind to get the better of her trigger finger, settling for a silver on the opening day of the Asian Games shooting competition.

Elavenil managed a total of 252.4 points over 24 shots to finish 0.6 adrift of Hinata Tanichi, the Japanese crawling her way to the top, one shot at a time. Korea's reigning Olympic champion Ban Hyojin finished third. But once the top-three were decided, it was all about the colour of the medal. Elavenil and India, though, had already assured themselves of a team silver even before the final began. Sonam Maskar and Vidarsa K. Vinod shooting high enough in the qualifying round ensured the three together would not go back empty-handed. Vidarsa shot 630.4 and with Sonam also qualifying for the top eight with an impressive 634.1, there were hopes of two In-



Plenty to smile: Elavenil had a big role in two podium finishes for India on the opening day of the shooting competition. R.V. MOORTHY

dians on the podium. And, for a while, the hopes seemed justified.

Sonam, in particular, had been very consistent all through the qualifying, not going below 105 in any of the six series of 10 shots

each. But one bad score on the 15th shot – a 9.9, her only bad shot of the day – ended her journey in sixth place. Elavenil, however, was in a different zone. Even as big names kept falling by the wayside – hol-



I was getting a little easy on my process, so I think I will have to get back and work on it more. It's been like this post-Paris [Olympics]. I am grateful I have been getting a lot of opportunities to learn, experiment and utilise my potential

der Han Jiayu was eliminated seventh and reigning Olympic champion and World No. 1 Wang Zefei was fifth – the 27-year-old kept increasing her lead.

Once the medallists were decided, however, it looked like Elavenil abruptly took her foot off the gas. Her scores dropped from high 10s to low 10s, she had a couple of 10.1s, and it was clear the spell had broken. Her lead at the top was still good enough to make it to the last two shots but its gradual erosion also saw her the top spot and the gold slipping away.

Earlier Vidarsa, having started strongly in the qualifications, ended with two low rounds of 104. 3 and 104.4, the last two series pulling her down to 12th place.

Qualifications World Record holder Wang, meanwhile, added a new Games and Asian qualifying record to her kitty with a total of 636.8.

Vidarsa is not done yet



Tasting success: Vidarsa, Sonam and Elavenil began India's medal hunt. R.V. MOORTHY

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

There is a lot Keralam is known for, including sports. Shooting, though, isn't one of them.

For Vidarsa K. Vinod, however, that made little difference in her pursuit of a sport that has now made her a famous shooter in the State.

On Sunday, after finishing 12th in the individual competition of the 10m air rifle at the Asian Games and winning a team silver, Vidarsa had no regrets.

"I am satisfied. My main event is 50m 3P and I am confident of that," Vidarsa told *The Hindu* at the range.

For someone who started 10m air rifle only to im-

prove her standing posture in the 50m, her rapid growth in the discipline has been remarkable.

"I was actually not even expecting to participate in both events. My first competition (in 10m) was in 2025 where I scored my personal best. That is when I realised I can do both," said Vidarsa, who began shooting only in 2018 as an NCC cadet in college.

Swift rise

The rise through the ranks, even with little competition, was swift – first within the State and then at the National level. The Asian Games, however, was a different ball game.

"After I got to know I had a chance to be selected

for the Asian Games, I was preparing mentally and physically. It took me almost eight years to achieve this and the journey was very difficult. There was a lot of struggle, self-doubt, failures... I kept asking myself whether I was on the right path and if I was doing the right thing," she had admitted in an exclusive interaction earlier in Bhopal.

Her first outing at the Games may not have been as rewarding as she would have liked but Vidarsa is ready for the long haul.

"Coming from a village where people have limited vision and ambition, I have always wanted more. I am not ready to give up on the face of failures," she promised.

I relaxed a bit, but gave my best: Elavenil

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

It was not a silver won but a gold lost for Elavenil Valarivan at the Aichi General Shooting Gallery on Sunday, the 27-year-old letting a sure title chance slip away by easing up too early in the final.

The wide smile she had after the event could not hide the 'what ifs' running through her mind.

"Somewhere I knew I was in the top three and although I was coming back to my process and techniques, I did get a bit relaxed.

"I really need to work on my [game in] finals. But I think I gave my absolute best," Elavenil said.

It was a candid admission by someone making her return to the Asian Games after an eight-year break, having missed out on the previous edition.

Sonam Maskar, who had only one bad shot of 9.9 through her entire competition and crashed out of medal contention, reacted similarly.

"I am not disappointed but I feel it could have been a better shot. I will work on it... I have to focus more on the process, work more on how to do better in finals".

'Medically unfit' Sanyal forced to withdraw

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Mixed Martial Arts (MMA) athlete Varun Sanyal, a late addition to the Indian squad for the Asian Games, was on Sunday forced to withdraw after being declared medically unfit for competition.

The 27-year-old, India's entry in the traditional 77kg, was found unconscious during a sauna session on the cruise ship Costa Serena while trying to cut his weight for the quarterfinal fight.

He was assessed by medical personnel, diagnosed as severely exhausted and dehydrated and declared unfit to compete.

The Indian Olympic Association said: "Sanyal suffered from generalised cramps and body ache while in the sauna last evening... He underwent medical examination and precautionary blood tests, which were normal. Despite rest, the following morning, he felt not fully fit to participate.

"After consultation with his coach, he withdrew on medical grounds".

Shafali goes berserk, India to play Sri Lanka for gold

Press Trust of India
NISSHIN

Reigning champion India stormed into the women's cricket T20I final at the Asian Games for a second successive edition, confirming at least a silver medal. The Women in Blue advanced to the gold-medal match with a crushing 114-run win over Bangladesh on Sunday.

Shafali Verma peeled off her maiden T20I century, an unbeaten 100 off just 49 balls (3x4, 9x6), to power India to a formidable 195 for four. The aggressive opener was well supported by Smriti Mandhana (37, 19b, 5x4, 2x6) and skipper Harmanpreet Kaur (40, 33b, 6x4) from the other end. The Bangladesh chase unravelled almost immediately as wickets fell at regular intervals, with the side eventually getting bowled out for just 81 in 15.4 overs.

Nandani Sharma returned three for 25 and even came close to taking a hat-trick in the 11th over.

India will face Sri Lanka in the gold-medal match on Tuesday, in a repeat of last edition's final.



Power and panache: Shafali's unbeaten century was studded with three fours and nine sixes. X@BCCIWOMEN

THE INDIA SHOW

A look at some Indian performances on Sunday:

Badminton: Women's team (round-of-16): bt Kazakhstan 3-0.

Cricket: Women (semifinal): bt Bangladesh by 114 runs.

Hockey: Women (Pool B): bt Uzbekistan 19-0; Men (Pool A): bt Indonesia 13-1.

Mixed Martial Arts: Women's Traditional -60kg (quarterfinal): Suchika bt Baigalmaa (Mgl) 2-0.

Shooting: Women (final): 10m air rifle individual: Elavenil (silver), Sonam (sixth); Team: Silver (Elavenil, Sonam, Vidarsa).

Swimming: Men: 100m

freestyle: Benedicton (12th overall), DNQ for final, Akash (23rd overall), DNQ for final; 100m backstroke: Rishabh (sixth in the final), Utkarsh (12th overall), DNQ for final.

Table tennis: Women's team (Group F): bt Indonesia 3-0; bt Singapore 3-2. Men's team (Group F): bt Indonesia 3-0; lost to Iran 0-3.

Teqball: Women's singles bronze match: Quimcy lost to Sakamoto (Jpn) 0-2; Mixed doubles bronze match: Quimcy & Anas lost to Nguyen & Trinh (Vie) 0-2.

Wushu: Men's Changquan final: Suraj (11th).

The scores:

India 195/4 in 20 overs (Smriti 37, Shafali 100 n.o., Harmanpreet 40) bt Bangladesh 81 in 15.4 overs (Nandani 3/25, Shree Charani 2/7,

Deepti 3/7).

Toss: India.

Pakistan 177/4 in 20 overs lost to Sri Lanka 178/2 in 17.5 overs.

Toss: Sri Lanka.

India blanks Kazakhstan, sets up clash with Japan

Press Trust of India
NAGOYA

India cruised past a lowly Kazakhstan 3-0 in the badminton women's team event at the Asian Games on Sunday, setting up a challenging quarterfinal against host Japan.

At the Ichinomiya City Municipal Gymnasium, P.V. Sindhu, Unnati Hooda and Tanvi Sharma completed a sweep without dropping a game.

The road from here is set to be a difficult one for India, which had returned empty-handed from Hangzhou in 2023.

"We have a good team. Japan is also good and strong, so it is going to be a tough one," Sindhu said about the upcoming clash.

"A lot of girls are playing at the Asian Games for the first time, so I am taking it (leadership) in a responsible way," the two-time Asiad medallist added.

The results: India bt Kazakhstan 3-0 (P.V. Sindhu bt Kamila Smagulova 21-7, 21-9; Unnati Hooda bt Alissa Kuleshova 21-7, 21-10; Tanvi Sharma bt Diana Namenova 21-5, 21-10).

India's hockey teams maul their opponents

Press Trust of India
KAKAMIGAHARA

Defending champion India produced a brilliant all-round performance led by striker Dilpreet Singh's four-goal haul to outplay unfancied Indonesia 13-1 in its opening men's Pool A match of the Asian Games here on Sunday.

Not to be left behind, young striker Deepika Sehrawat slammed in a record-shattering eight goals as the Indian women hammered lowly Uzbekistan 19-0 in a Pool B game.

All of Dilpreet's strikes were field goals while Shilanand Lakra and Sukhjeet Singh scored a brace each.

Dilpreet credited the team effort and said that the focus was on winning gold and ensuring a direct

ticket to the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics.

"We played really well. We are focused on our basics and game structures. It's mostly about penalty corners, how to get them and score goals."

Deepika's was the best performance by an Indian woman in an Asian Games match.

The results:

Women: Pool B: India 19 (Lalremisiami 7, Deepika Sehrawat 8, 22, 25, 33, 36, 38, 41, 54, Ishika Chaudhary 11, 42, 54, Baljeet Kaur 12, Neha 18, Navneet Kaur 23, 45, Lalthantluangi 43, 51, Sakshi Rana 43) bt Uzbekistan 0.

Men: Pool A: India 13 (Shilanand Lakra 6, 35, Abhishek 12, Dilpreet 18, 19, 37, 49, Rajinder Singh 19, Mandeep Singh 21, Harmanpreet Singh 28, Sukhjeet Singh 38, 48, Jugraj Singh 47) bt Indonesia 1 (Aulia Al Ardh 33).



Field day: Indian women put 19 past Uzbekistan. HOCKEYINDIA

INDIANS IN ACTION

A look at some Indian players/teams who will compete on Monday (all times IST):

BADMINTON
Men's team (round-of-16): vs. Bangladesh, 11.30 a.m.

BOXING
Men's 70kg (round-of-32): Sumit vs. Bunjong (Tha), 2.45 p.m.

HOCKEY
Women (Pool B): vs. Indonesia, 9.30 a.m.

KABADDI
Men (Group A): vs. Japan, 9.45 a.m.; Women (Group A): vs. Bangladesh, 4.15 p.m.

MIXED MARTIAL ARTS
Women's Traditional -60kg (semifinal): Suchika vs. Hoon (Sgp), 8.30 a.m.

SHOOTING
Men: 10m air rifle individual qualification and team final (Himanshu, Parth, Rudrankksh), 6.15 a.m.; individual final, 9 a.m.; Skeet individual qualification and team final - Day 1 (Mairaj, Anantjeet, Bhavtegh), 6.30 a.m.; Women: Skeet individual qualification and team final - Day 1 (Parinaaz, Raiza, Maheshwari), 6.30 a.m.

SWIMMING
Men: Heats (from 6.30 a.m.): 50m backstroke (Rishabh, Srihari); 50m freestyle (Akash, Heer); 100m breaststroke (Danush); 4x200m freestyle relay; finals (from 1.30 p.m.).

TABLE TENNIS
Women's team (Group F): vs. Pakistan, 6.30 a.m.; Men's team (Group F): vs. Pakistan, 3.30 p.m.

WUSHU
Women's Changquan final: Wangsu, 5.30 a.m.



SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

R. Kaushik

In an era where opening the batting in Test cricket revolved around giving the first hour, if not the first session, to the bowlers, K. Srikkanth was a glorious exception to the accepted rule. High on risk and therefore a little short on consistency, the maverick from Tamil Nadu was unstoppable when in the mood, treating the best fast bowlers in the world with utter disdain. Mark Greatbatch at the 1992 World Cup, and Sanath Jayasuriya in 1996, are often eulogised for changing the face of opening the batting, but long before these two left-handers left their mark, Srikkanth had made hitting over the top fashionable. With complete and utter disregard for reputations, and with a nonchalance that comes only to the chosen few. Strategies chalked at team meetings, he was told, need not concern him. First Sunil Gavaskar, and then Kapil Dev, encouraged Srikkanth to be himself, to bat with natural flair and flamboyance. No one expected him to bat like Gavaskar, studied in defence and treating each ball

assiduously on its merit because, well, he wouldn't be Srikkanth then, would he? And so, the right-hander went on a rampage whenever he could.

Not an accurate picture

A Test average of 29.88 from 43 matches, and a 50-over international average of 29.01 spread across 145 innings, do not paint an accurate picture of the potential for mayhem that he possessed. Srikkanth was a lot more than the sum of his six international hundreds and the highest individual tally in a low-scoring final of the 1983 World Cup, because the entertainment he provided and the value he brought with him to the batting crease were beyond parallel in that time and age. Srikkanth was a pioneer, without question, his brand of batsmanship unique and remarkably enviable in his time in international cricket. The subsequent emergence of a host of destructive openers, among them a certain Sachin Tendulkar who was thrust into the role of an ODI opener almost accidentally in 1994 and who went on to finish with 49 international tons in the 50-over version, is a back-handed

compliment to the Srikkanth school of aggression that has gained immense currency in the last two and a quarter decades, from the time the 20-over iteration stormed cricketing consciousness. Virender Sehwag and Chris Gayle made a name for themselves by beautifully fusing untold havoc with stunning consistency. Both openers, the former converted from a middle-order practitioner, signed off with two Test triple tons apiece - with only the great Don Bradman and Brian Lara for company in that exclusive club of four - to reiterate that aggressive batting need not be at the expense of sustained masterpieces.

Having grown up watching the deeds of these two stalwarts, among others, Abhishek Sharma has now burst forth as a modern-day six-hitting behemoth against whom the margin for error is miniscule and to whom clearing the boundary boards is little more than child's play. Abhishek is now 26, still some way short of hitting his peak as a batter. Internationally, he figures in only one format and it is only a matter of time before he is allowed to spread his wings and dot the 50-over landscape too with spectacular edifices. But even in that one limited-overs format, he has showcased a penchant for the bold and the beautiful that is impossible to miss. Numerous batters who have failed to tickle the scorers in their first international innings have had a stellar career, not least the legendary G.R. Vishwanath, who followed up nought in the first innings of his debut Test against Australia in Kanpur in 1969 with 137 of the best in the second dig. Abhishek's international career too got off to the most inauspicious of beginnings - he fell for a second-ball duck against Zimbabwe in Harare in July 2024 - but the very next day, he made the world sit up and take notice by smashing a 47-ball century against the same opponents, now thoroughly shell-shocked.

It was evident even at that early stage that this was a special talent that needed to be encouraged rather than fettered, that was best left to its own devices so that he could learn from his mistakes and polish the rough edges instead of being instructed to redefine his high-risk approach. Abhishek took some time in striking the right balance between all-out attack and judiciousness in shot-selection, but once he found the magic formula, he has been an unstoppable force at the highest level. Abhishek has played 58 T20I innings, which is a fairly reasonable sample size. Despite taking the fight to the bowlers, he has blasted three hundreds and 12 half-centuries. Despite his propensity to hit the ball in the air, he averages 33.17. And because he loves dismantling attacks and bruising egos, he has been able to strike at an extraordinary 194.55, laced with 182 fours and 126 sixes.

Every year since its inception, the Indian Premier League rewards the highest scorer of the season with the Orange Cap. In so many ways, that is incongruous because T20 cricket is seldom about quantum. It is about impact, it's about the value of the runs made. Given that eight-ball 25s are seen as being more crucial than 35-ball half-centuries, strike-rate would appear to be a logical route to deciding the significance of a batter to his team's fortunes, but strike-rate alone can't be the criterion if it rewards only cameos and disregards more meaningful contributions.

Various quarters have advocated using average and strike-rate in tandem to decide the worth of a batter. The former is a marker of consistency, the latter a pointer to explosiveness. In Abhishek's case, combining the average and the strike-rate in T20Is will give him a whopping total of 227.72. Now, while that is just a number, it is a more accurate reflection of the kind of havoc he can wreak. Abhishek's latest epic came on Thursday night at the National capital's Arun Jaitley Stadium. In the last of three T20Is that Afghanistan hosted against India in India last Thursday, Abhishek's most unforgiving avatar was on full view. In a mere 30 deliveries, he raced to his third T20I century, a good 19 months after his previous ton, against England in Mumbai in February 2025.

The hundred included nine fours and 10 sixes - 96% of his runs came in boundaries - and by the time he was dismissed, he had added one more six in his final score of 108, off a ridiculous 34 balls. It is the fastest T20I hundred against a full-member nation, the fastest ton internationally in the 20-over game by a batter from a full-member country.

Quips that Abhishek defeated the Afghans by 14 runs weren't just cute. They aptly illustrated the full weight of his dominance against a bowling group that is pedestrian by no stretch of the imagination. Afghanistan might be a little undercooked when it comes to batting in the topmost echelons, but as a bowling unit, they hardly suffer in comparison. Rashid Khan, Fazalhaq Farooqi, Mujeeb Ur Rahman and Mohammad Nabi form a formidable quartet, but Abhishek left



Abhishek's latest epic came at the National capital's Arun Jaitley Stadium. In the last of three T20Is that Afghanistan hosted against India in India, his most unforgiving avatar was on full view. In a mere 30 deliveries, he raced to his third T20I century, a good 19 months after his previous ton, against England in Mumbai in February 2025

them quivering in their collective boots, waiting for and ruthlessly punishing any indiscretion in length or direction with the most scything, punitive of willows. In the two preceding matches of the series at the same venue, Abhishek had reeled off scores of 82 (32b) and 39 (19b) respectively. His lowest strike-rate (205.26) came in game two, sandwiched between similar efforts of 256.25 and 317.64, the latter killing any competitive interest in the dead rubber just a quarter of the way into the no-contest.

It was Abhishek at his majestic best, unhurried and unflustered, using a strong base as his ally and carefully eschewing the premeditation that has left many a batter horribly out of position. Abhishek seldom uses exaggerated foot movement whilst waiting for the bowler to deliver the ball, nor does he often seek recourse to the unconventional such as the reverse-scoop or a switch hit.

His areas of preference are in front of square rather than behind it. A beautiful bat-swing with the willow on the downward curve can be mesmerising and because Abhishek strikes the ball cleanly and down the ground, it's more than likely that he will forever be one step ahead of the opposition. The effortlessness with which he sends the ball soaring deep into the stands is audaciously breathtaking in its simplicity and for the debilitating (for the bowlers) outcome from which there is no recovery.

The very nature of the T20 beast is such that it is almost an antidote to consistency. The consensus is that opening batters are best placed to stack up all the records, and there is no arguing with that because, after all, they are in a position to play more deliveries than those succeeding them in the batting order. But the propensity to push the envelope manifests itself in greater risk-taking when the field restrictions are in place, which automatically brings with it the threat of courting cheap dismissals.

Conservatism has been thrown out of the window a long time back. India are the leaders, in a manner of speaking, in setting the tone, having woken up to the demands of the format a little later than some others, and have now meticulously pieced together an amazing set of destroyers with Abhishek as the primary wrecking ball. The Afghanistan series saw him at his fiercely consistent best. He had a reasonably forgettable T20 World Cup; three ducks at the start were only marginally offset by a blazing half-century in the final, but he seems to have rediscovered his mojo now, which is an excellent sign with the Asian Games gold medal defence now exactly a week away.

Furious competition

Abhishek will be keen to show that there is more to him than just a 20-over marauder. There is furious competition for top-order places in the 50-over setup, with someone like Yashasvi Jaiswal, who has two hundreds in his last three ODI innings, struggling to break through. Abhishek's List A (domestic 50-over) record isn't trifling - he averages 33.78 while striking at 100.18 in 68 innings - but while he will be keen to evolve as a multi-format performer, he won't lose any sleep over his longer-version future.

For now, his calling is in T20s and that's where he will try to maximise his efficacy and get the team off to the kind of starts they have come to take for granted. He won't be fazed by the fact that Vaibhav Sooryavanshi is breathing down his neck, or that there are other acknowledged ball-bashers aspiring for higher honours. Abhishek has found his Zen state - India's pride, the rest of the world's envy.

THE GIST

Abhishek took some time in striking the right balance between all-out attack and judiciousness in shot-selection, but once he found the magic formula, he has been an unstoppable force at the highest level

He has played 58 T20I innings, which is a fairly reasonable sample size. Despite taking the fight to the bowlers, he has blasted three hundreds and 12 half-centuries

Since the southpaw strikes the ball cleanly and down the ground, it's more than likely that he will forever be one step ahead of the opposition



Behind every treated animal stands a veterinarian carrying unseen strain

Unlike human medicine, where every organ often has its own specialist, veterinary medicine asks one person to be all of them at once

Vasini Varadan

While much of society is preoccupied with animal rights, there is a population facing a significant risk of burnout yet which often goes unacknowledged: veterinarians. Often underestimated as a profession and underfunded as a field, veterinary medicine carries expectations that far exceed what can reasonably be asked of any one individual. Veterinarians are expected to deliver unwavering care, often at the cost of their own. Like all healthcare professionals, they navigate long hours, emergencies, and loss. But they also have distinct challenges. Their patients cannot speak, forcing vets to rely on instinct as much as expertise. They must master multiple anatomies across species. They absorb not only the suffering of animals, but also the emotional intensity of anxious, grieving pet owners. And uniquely, they carry the burden of deciding when a life should end, often without adequate emotional support for the weight of the decisions made and the grief that comes with executing it. What they experience is not simply burnout, a condition caused by prolonged stress, but also compassion fatigue (from caring unconditionally) and moral injury (having to make decisions that go against their core moral beliefs). Over time, all of this takes a toll. Unlike human medicine, where every

organ has its own specialist, veterinary medicine asks one person to be all of them at once. Across a single day, they shift roles constantly: diagnosing, fixing, reassuring, improvising. It's not just about treating animals, it's about carrying an entire system of care in one body, adapting to whatever walks (or is carried) through the door. Alongside their patients, vets take on the emotional aftermath, anger, disappointment, and grief of pet owners. They linger long after the consultation ends. A euthanasia need not end the day. It is often followed by the next appointment with no space or time in between to process the loss or the weight of the decision. The rise of alternative medicine which is often cheaper brings another consequence: time lost. If the alternate treatment has not worked, there is delay in diagnosis, treatment and loss of life which falls at the hands of the vet. Burnout, compassion fatigue, and moral injury show up in both mind and body as insomnia, brain fog, exhaustion, memory lapses and sometimes other physical illnesses. Their work is not the problem. Most vets still care deeply about healing. It is a system defined by overwork, emotional labour, a variety of pressures, tough decisions, and financial limitations: it is meant to support them but often does the opposite. (Vasini Varadan is a cartoonist and illustrator. vasinivaradan@gmail.com)



Like all healthcare professionals, vets navigate long hours, emergencies, and loss. But they also face distinct challenges. Representative image. MIKHAIL NILOV/PEXELS



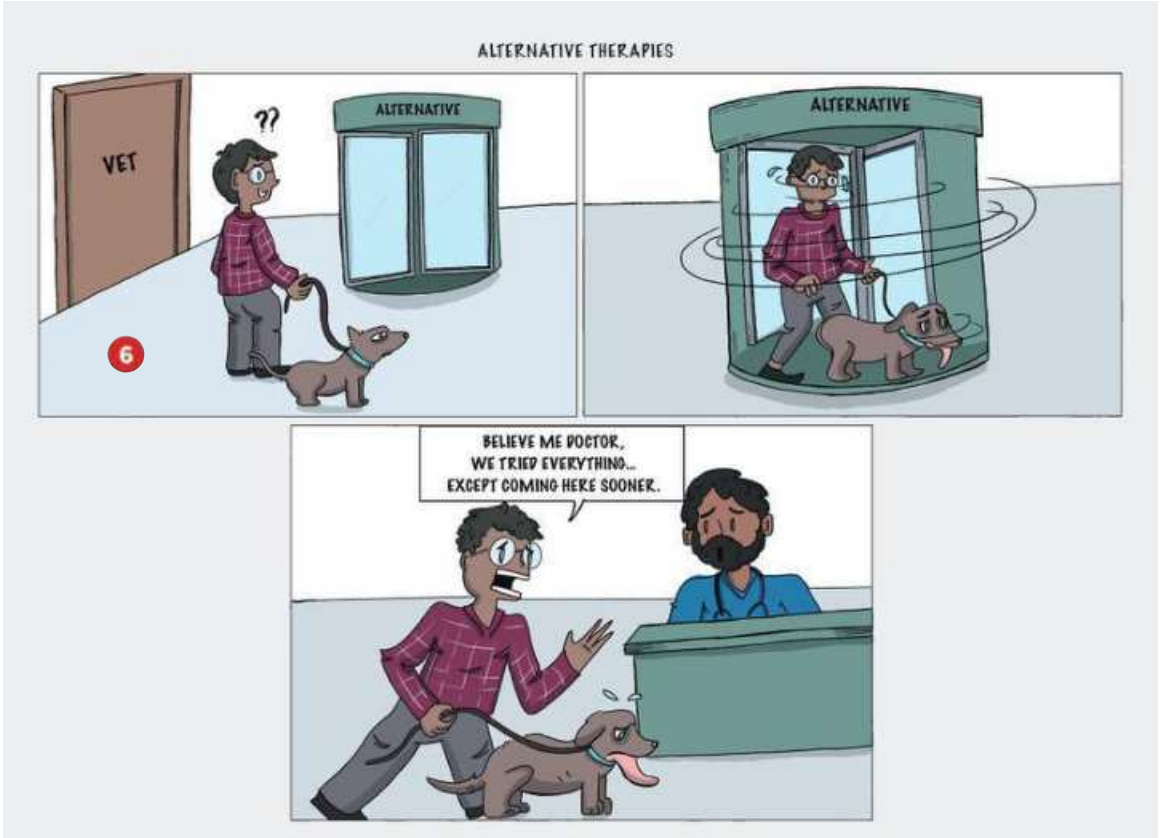
A study found that poachers consistently targeted 'charismatic' and high-value species, such as macaws, at unsustainable rates. GETTY IMAGES

Urban demand is reorganising global wildlife trafficking web

Divya Gandhi

Some 2,000 km away from their natural habitat in the rainforests of Borneo and Sumatra, five listless baby orangutans were found, bafflingly, in a forest in the middle of Odisha on September 8. Videos were shared widely showing the critically endangered apes, each around a year old, with limited mobility, huddled together, chomping on bananas from a container. Then more videos emerged of the group being bottle-fed in a Bhubaneswar Zoo, where they are now being monitored. Jose Louies, CEO of the Wildlife Trust of India, said it is clear these animals had been kept in captivity for a while, going by their complete lack of fear of humans. CITES prohibits the commercial trade in orangutans but these animals are routinely sold as exotic pets and can cost up to ₹20 lakh each. The discovery has renewed discourse on wildlife trafficking. India's Wildlife Crime Control Bureau has been asked to investigate the matter. There are many enigmas: How were they trafficked? By sea? Air? Road? Who captured and smuggled them? And who are their collectors? This is not the first time these apes have been found in India. In 2022, two baby orangutans were found abandoned near the Assam-Mizoram border. A study published in the *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* has integrated 30 years of confiscation data and spatial network analysis to unravel the trade routes of another much-trafficked species, Mexico's parrots, from biodiverse habitats to urban centres around the world, and could provide clues to criminal networks in other parts of the world.

Today, urban centres are the nexuses of demand, the paper added. "For many commonly traded species, confiscations occurred hundreds of kilometers from their native habitats, frequently in major cities like Mexico City." And this demand is reorganising the global wildlife trafficking network. No less than half of Mexico's native parrot species are directly threatened by the illegal wildlife trade, the researchers said, "elevating their risk of extinction". They found that poachers consistently targeted "charismatic," and high-value species, particularly macaws and Amazon parrots. The team's methods can be adapted to map other complex illicit networks, such as the trafficking of timber, marine life or even drugs and weapons. Drug cartels in Mexico also often run illegal logging operations, sharing transport logistics and laundering illicit timber alongside narcotics, the paper said. Illicit wildlife networks are converging with broader organised crime, and criminal networks that "are complex, adaptive, and largely invisible, making them notoriously difficult to map, track, and disrupt," said the authors. And this, it added, needs a new approach "to move from enforcement-based, isolated seizures to a predictive understanding of network structure and vulnerability." The lacunae in understanding mechanisms that feed criminal networks comes in the way of law enforcement, the team added, adding that illegal wildlife trade "comprises global, multibillion-dollar criminal enterprises that threaten biodiversity and elevate the risk of zoonotic disease transfer and emergence". As for India, primates, turtles, and lizards are the most smuggled illegal species into the country, Dr. Jose told *The Hindu*, primarily through land routes between India and Myanmar. "The criminal network is amoebic in nature: it configures and re-configures to safeguard the business," he said.



For feedback and suggestions for 'Science', please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject 'Daily page'

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Number of Karnataka taluks to be declared drought-hit

200 More than 200 taluks across Karnataka are likely to be included in the drought-affected list as the government assesses them in phases based on prescribed criteria and ground-truthing, Deputy Chief Minister G Parameshwara said on Sunday. PTI

Ambedkar statues vandalised in Uttar Pradesh

151 Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav on Sunday said 151 statues of B.R. Ambedkar were damaged across 72 districts of Uttar Pradesh during the BJP's rule, but only 14 arrests have been made so far. He alleged that the vandalism was done deliberately. PTI

Record-high average French diesel prices amid oil disruption

2.41 in €. French diesel prices hit a fresh record on Sunday, as the West Asia war disrupts oil supplies. The price per litre stood at €2.41 euros (\$2.76 dollars). Prices have been soaring across the world after the U.S. and Israel launched their war against Iran in February. PTI

Number of miners in Nigeria who died in detention

37 Thirty-seven young men were found dead inside a crowded cell in Minna, the capital of central Niger state, on Thursday. Survivors recounted being crammed in the cell with poor ventilation, and one said a substance that stung their throats and noses was sprayed into the cell. AFP

Number of people missing in Nepal flash floods

6,000 Search operations continued in Nepal on Sunday for around 6,000 people who are still unaccounted for nearly four weeks after the devastating flash floods that killed more than 1,400. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

Follow us  facebook.com/thehindu  X.com/the_hindu  instagram.com/the_hindu

The copyright stakes in the EU FTA

Draft India-EU FTA's copyright provisions could require changes to India's Copyright Act and weaken existing exceptions for students, archivists, Internet service providers; negotiators must seek to restore the WIPO Copyright Treaty to the National Treatment clause and preserve the country's digital copyright flexibilities

ECONOMIC NOTES

Zakir Thomas
Biswajit Dhar

Recently, the European Commission formally requested EU member states to approve the signing and conclusion of the India-EU Free Trade Agreement. Details of the commitments the two partners have accepted in the covered areas, including intellectual property (IP), have also been revealed. The draft IP Chapter includes detailed provisions on copyright that require close examination of their impact on India's digital policy landscape.

The structural asymmetry

Our assessment is that the provisions in the draft IP Chapter would necessitate amendments to India's Copyright Act, 1957, which is in conformity with international IP treaties including the WIPO Copyright Treaty (WCT) and the Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS) Agreement. Though the current provisions explicitly affirm the commitments of both parties to these IP treaties, they omit the WCT from the crucial National Treatment clause (Article 10.8).

It may be noted that the WCT was specifically adopted for the protection of works and the rights of their authors in the digital environment, particularly software and databases, while also providing for technological protection measures (TPMs). Excluding the WCT from the National Treatment provisions of the IP Chapter implies that the limitations on or exceptions to copyright for digital works that the WCT provides (Article 10) would henceforth be unavailable to India.

Limitations and exceptions under the FTA (Article 10.21) include a narrow "three-step test", borrowed from EU copyright statutes. If the extant exceptions in India's Copyright Act are not preserved, foreign rightsholders could challenge the exceptions for digital works available under Section 52 (or "fair dealing"), including transient or



GETTY IMAGES

incidental storage of a work or performance purely in the technical process of electronic transmission or communication to the public under Article 10.11 of the FTA, subjecting them to civil and criminal remedies.

The danger becomes more apparent when read alongside Footnote 1 of Article 10.8(1), which expands "protection" to cover enforcement measures against the circumvention of TPMs (Article 10.18) and Rights Management Information (Article 10.19). By including WCT's enforcement mandates among the binding obligations while excluding this treaty from the National Treatment exceptions, the draft IP Chapter abandons the WCT's principles, namely, balancing authors' rights with public interest exceptions in education and research, while providing a rigid enforcement mandate.

This structural imbalance directly threatens Section 65A of India's Copyright Act, 1957, which deals with TPMs. Section 65A(2) provides exceptions under which technological protection can be circumvented, particularly for the purposes permitted therein. Thus, if a student or researcher bypasses a digital lock to perform a lawful act protected under Section 52, no criminal liability attaches.

Chilling effect on classrooms, labs

The real-world consequences of this legal

shift will be borne by India's academic and educational institutions. Under Sections 52(1)(ab) and (ac) of the Copyright Act, engineering students and security researchers are legally permitted to observe, test, and reverse-engineer software to foster interoperability or uncover critical security vulnerabilities.

Yet, modern software is almost universally guarded by encryption and digital access controls.

Under a strict anti-circumvention regime, a computer science student breaking a digital lock to inspect code for system compatibility or security flaws could be transformed overnight into a legal offender. Similarly, public libraries and academic archives face unprecedented risks. In an era when historical documents, literature, and research are increasingly distributed in digital formats burdened by Digital Rights Management (DRM), librarians depend on format-shifting to archive out-of-print works and preserve fragile collections. A strict anti-circumvention rule would strip archivists of the legal right to bypass digital locks for preservation.

Furthermore, as higher education relies more on electronic materials, paywalls and DRM controls could effectively overwrite the public interest protections established by Indian courts in landmark rulings such as the DU Photocopy Case.

Threat to Internet service providers

Under India's Copyright Act (Sections 52(1)(b) and (c)), Internet service providers (ISPs) and digital intermediaries are shielded from liability for the temporary, transient copies created in RAM and server caches during routine data routing. The notice and takedown regime established under Rule 75 of the Copyright Rules, 2013 relies on these statutory safe harbours.

The FTA draft undermines this framework by granting rightsholders an exclusive, unqualified right over all "temporary or permanent" reproductions under Article 10.11(a), in contravention of the Agreed Statements to Article 8 and Article 10 of the WCT, which exempt transient network copies from copyright liability. Exclusion of the WCT from the National Treatment exception could, therefore, leave ISPs at risk of legal challenge, with EU rightsholders exposing Indian intermediaries to systemic liability.

By agreeing to the draft text, the negotiators seem to have gone beyond the Indian Parliament's mandate as reflected in the Copyright Act, 1957. Left uncorrected, this would oblige Parliament to remove the exceptions covering digital works in the Act, regardless of whether the user was engaging in legitimate, lawful research.

A call for recalibration

India's policy flexibilities must not be traded away in bilateral trade bargains. Our negotiators must insist on targeted revisions. They should press to re-insert the WCT into the National Treatment Clause. India's rise as a digital powerhouse rests on a foundation of open access to knowledge, robust educational inquiry, and independent technical research. While deepening trade ties with the EU is crucial, this must not be at the expense of our digital sovereignty or our students' right to learn. Negotiators must ensure the availability of statutory flexibilities in the copyright domain that keep Indian innovation alive. (Zakir Thomas is the IPR Chair at National Law School of India University, Bengaluru and Biswajit Dhar was the IPR Chair Professor at JNU)

THE GIST

The draft IP Chapter omits the WIPO Copyright Treaty from the National Treatment clause while retaining its enforcement mandates on technological protection measures and rights management information

A strict anti-circumvention regime could expose students and security researchers to liability for bypassing digital locks while reverse-engineering software or examining security vulnerabilities

Public libraries and academic archives could face restrictions on format-shifting digital works, while Internet service providers could face liability over temporary copies created during routine data routing

What does Tulu's new official language status mean?

How will the new status change the use of Tulu in administration? Is the Cabinet's decision enough?

Raviprasad Kamila

The story so far:

Karnataka government, in its Cabinet meeting held in Mangaluru on September 18, decided to accord the additional official (administrative) language status to Tulu, which is commonly spoken in Dakshina Kannada district, southern parts of Udupi district in Karnataka, and northern parts of Kasaragod district in Kerala. While making the announcement, Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar said the status will apply to administrative matters in the two districts. The government will release ₹82 lakh annually for translation, training and language usage purposes.

How will the decision help people?

B. Shivarama Shetty, former Project Director, Centre of Excellence for Studies

in Classical Kannada, Central Institute of Indian Languages (CIIL), Mysuru, said that elected representatives can speak in Tulu at gram sabhas of gram panchayats, taluk panchayats, and zilla panchayats meetings. It also applies to urban local body meetings such as city corporation council, city municipal council and town municipal council meetings. The government circulars and orders issued in the two districts should also contain Tulu. People can submit applications to government departments in Tulu. This will make officials who do not know Tulu depend on translations, translators, or learn the basics of Tulu.

When did the government move to grant official status to Tulu begin?

When the BJP government was in power, the then Minister for Kannada and Culture, V. Sunil Kumar, on January 30, 2023, formed a committee headed by M.

Mohan Alva, Chairman, Alva's Education Foundation, Moodbidri, Dakshina Kannada, to study and submit a report on declaring Tulu as the second official language of Karnataka.

The committee was asked to submit its report to the government in a week. According to Mr. Kumar, the BJP government could not grant official language status to Tulu because the model code of conduct for the 2023 Assembly elections in Karnataka was declared on March 29, 2023, and the BJP lost power in the elections.

Later, the Congress government took over in Karnataka. It appointed a committee led by K. M. Gayatri, Director of Kannada and Culture, to study the procedures adopted by the Andhra Pradesh government to grant additional language status to Urdu.

This committee visited Andhra Pradesh on January 19 and 20, 2026 and studied

how Urdu is being used in administration. The committee submitted its report to the Karnataka government on March 4, against the backdrop of the move to declare Tulu as the additional official language.

Is the Cabinet's decision enough?

Article 345 of the Constitution allows each State legislature to choose one or more regional languages or Hindi as the official language for its official work. It says: "Subject to the provisions of articles 346 and 347, the Legislature of a State may by law adopt any one or more of the languages in use in the State or Hindi as the language or languages to be used for all or any of the official purposes of that State."

Section 2 of the Karnataka Official Language Act, 1963 states that Kannada is the official language.

Some law graduates say that if Karnataka is to implement the Cabinet's decision, it will have to amend the Karnataka Official Language Act to incorporate Tulu as an additional administrative language in Dakshina Kannada and Udupi districts. Once the amendment is approved by the appropriate authority, the Governor, the government will issue a notification, following which the Cabinet's decision will come into force. The governments of Andhra Pradesh and Telangana followed

the same procedure – amending their respective language laws – to declare Urdu as the second official language of their States.

How is this language introduced in academics?

Tulu is taught as the third optional language in schools, from Class 6 to Class 10, in Dakshina Kannada and Udupi districts. It was first introduced for Class 6 in the 2010-11 academic year. It is not being taught as a subject in pre-university and degree classes. Mangalore University introduced a two-year Tulu postgraduation programme in its erstwhile University Evening College (now closed down) in 2018-19. The programme was wound up from the academic year 2024-25, citing a lack of students in double digits who applied to join the programme.

Is it an independent language?

The Registrar General and Census Commissioner has recognised Tulu as an independent language of India ever since the department was established, and the Census Report gives statistics about Tulu speakers as a separate linguistic community.

It is treated as an important non-scheduled language of India. But it is not included in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution.

